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IN BRIEF

Six, including OSD to Mann, booked in 'graft' case

CHANDIGARH
A day after the Punjab and Haryana High Court directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations linked to Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann's office, the probe agency on Tuesday registered an FIR and booked six persons, including Rajbir Ghuman, the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the CM. » [Page 4](#)

10 Rajya Sabha seats in U.P. set to face no contest

LUCKNOW
The Samajwadi Party (SP) on Tuesday decided not to field a third candidate for the Rajya Sabha election in Uttar Pradesh, clearing the decks for all 10 seats to be filled without a contest. The ruling BJP has fielded eight candidates and the SP two. » [Page 3](#)

Anti-dam stir: call to withdraw forces from Siang belt

GUWAHATI
A tribal youth body in Arunachal Pradesh has asked the government to withdraw the Central Armed Police Forces and State Police personnel deployed to allegedly quell protests against the pre-feasibility report and surveys for a proposed mega hydropower project. » [Page 4](#)

OPPORTUNITIES » [PAGE 3](#)

Rahul calls SIR 'treason' as INDIA unites against ECI; MPs detained

LoP leads sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan after protest march to ECI headquarters stopped; PM Modi 'stole votes to hijack the country', he says; Opposition leaders demand CEC's removal, suspension of SIR, and restoration of deleted names in rolls

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

“What has been done to my country is treason,” Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said on Thursday even as Opposition parties closed ranks, marching from Parliament to the Election Commission of India's (ECI) headquarters to demand the scrapping of special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, restoring the names deleted from the rolls, and sacking of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Later in the evening, Mr. Gandhi, his sister, the Wayanad MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, and other MPs were detained and huddled into a bus even as Mr. Gandhi resisted, attempting to wriggle out of the vehicle's window.

Before being detained, Mr. Gandhi, along with Ms. Vadra and Congress leader K.C. Venugopal, held a sit-in at Akashvani Bhavan – the headquarters of All India Radio, just metres away from Nirvachan Sadan, where the protest march was stopped at 11 a.m. by Delhi Police.

By evening, the number of protesters inside Akashvani Bhawan swelled as several other parliamentarians joined. Trinamool's Derek O' Brien and Mahua Moitra, whom the Delhi Police had earlier removed, returned to join Mr. Gandhi.

While the Aam Aadmi Party and Dravida Munne-

Rally call: Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra on barricades during the INDIA bloc-led protest march, demanding CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, in New Delhi on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

tra Kazhagam stayed away from the protest, all 19 parties that attended the September 30 Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) meeting were represented.

United front
Opposition leaders, including Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Trinamool national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee, Shiv Sena (UBT)'s Sanjay Raut, and NCP (SP)'s Supriya Sule, were seen walking together. For the first time, Biju Janata Dal, which has maintained distance from both the ruling side and the INDIA bloc, joined in. Mr. Yadav accused the

ECI of working for the BJP. “Only BJP members can vote. BJP's workers can be India's citizens,” he said, accusing the government of using multiple measures to “steal the mandate”.

The SP chief accused the ECI of especially targeting the “*pichde* (backward), Dalit and *alpsankhyak* (minorities)”. Mr. Banerjee was seen raising slogans while standing alongside Mr. Gandhi.

The march began at 10.30 a.m. from Makar Dwar of Parliament, with the leaders carrying a banner reading: “Election Commission is compromised – sack Gyanesh Kumar”. At Akashvani Bha-

wan, after being stopped by police, the leaders sat down, raising slogans against Mr. Kumar and the government. Slogans such as “*vote chor gaddi chodh*” (vote thief leave the seat), “*Gyanesh Kumar istifa do*” (Gyanesh Kumar resign) were raised, and leaders were seen carrying placards reading “*BJP hi CEC hai*” and “Democracy not for sale”. Mr. Gandhi, Mr. Banerjee, Samajwadi Party's Akshay Yadav, and very briefly Ms. Vadra climbed the barricades.

CONTINUED ON
» [PAGE 10](#)
INSIDE THE SIEGE
» [PAGE 11](#)

Could not accept 'unusual demand' for meet outside premises: ECI

NEW DELHI
The Election Commission of India (ECI) said on Tuesday that INDIA bloc parties had demanded a meeting with the full commission at a venue outside its premises which was “unusual” and therefore “could not be accepted”. The poll body said that it had proposed that its senior-most officer on duty could be sent to the meeting venue, adding that this “unprecedented” offer was also declined by the protesting leaders. » [PAGE 11](#)

Pioneer of IceCube neutrino detector wins physics Nobel

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

This year's Nobel Prize in Physics will be awarded to Belgium-born Francis Halzen, 82, for his contributions to IceCube, a neutrino observatory in the South Pole, and for the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin.

While there are several massive detectors for these extremely elusive particles, IceCube is designed to find high-energy neutrinos that are believed to have originated far in space from energetic collisions. These “cosmic neutrinos” with extremely high energies are very rare and an enormous volume of ice is needed to observe an adequate number of collisions.

Mr. Halzen, who is presently at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, in the U.S., first presented his vision for capturing neutrinos at the South Pole in 1988. Pure, undisturbed ice is an ideal medium to capture these neutrinos: when they occasionally collide with atomic nuclei, they produce charged particles that announce themselves as a flash of pale blue light.

The South Pole's ice has many advantages, as it is free from various types of interference and the area is geologically stable. Mr. Halzen's idea caught on and, just a few years later, preliminary testing was conducted on sensors in ice. IceCube covers an entire cubic kilometre (or about 917 million litres of water) and was completed in 2010. It has 5,160 optical sensors to detect the Che-

Francis Halzen

renkov light produced by neutrino interactions, with its principal scientific focus on higher-energy astrophysical neutrinos.

The Cherenkov light is the blue flash produced when a charged particle travels through a transparent medium faster than light can travel through that medium. Researchers reported the first high-energy cosmic neutrinos in 2013 and, in 2018, traced one such neutrino to a distant blazar, a galaxy with a supermassive black hole at its centre that fires a jet of particles and radiation almost directly towards earth.

“Francis Halzen has led an international team of researchers and engineers who have provided us with a fantastic instrument. His tenacity and scientific vision has paved the way for a new kind of astronomy,” Mark Pearce, Chair of the Nobel Committee for Physics, said. The neutrino interactions that are continuously collected by IceCube will provide researchers with knowledge about the violent settings in which high-energy neutrinos can be created – and could even reveal previously unknown cosmic phenomena, a statement added.

EDITORIAL
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HIGH TURNOUT IN T.N.

Bypolls held for one LS seat, 5 Assembly seats

NEWS » [PAGE 10](#)

TUMULTUOUS CAREER

Bestselling novelist Jeffrey Archer dies

WORLD » [PAGE 14](#)



SMRITI TAKES OVER

Harmanpreet quits as India captain

SPORT » [PAGE 15](#)



Centre plans 5-pronged reform as GST panel meets tomorrow

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The Centre will propose a five-pronged plan for the next set of reforms to the Goods and Services Tax (GST) system at the upcoming GST Council meeting on Thursday, according to sources in the Union Finance Ministry.

These reforms are aimed at automating and easing a lot of the current administrative bottlenecks in the GST system, and reducing the compliance burden, especially for small businesses. Rates, including the GST on the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on UPI transactions, will not be on the agenda.

The five-pronged proposal covers process reforms, structural reforms, ease of living and doing business, exports of services, and e-commerce.

Some of the key changes proposed involve automatic invoice matching between buyers and sellers, reducing paperwork

Reform proposal

The five-pronged plan aims at automating and easing administrative bottlenecks in the GST system

FOCUS ON:	
■ Process reforms	■ Key beneficiaries will be small businesses, inter-State businesses, and service exporters
■ Structural reforms	
■ Ease of living and doing business	■ The proposals will be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner
■ Export of services	
■ E-commerce	

around claiming input tax credits (ITC), reducing the number of times small taxpayers have to file returns, and removing multi-state registrations for small businesses looking to sell across the country.

Relief measures

The Centre will be sharing a concept note with the States on allowing small taxpayers who supply only to consumers to file their returns once a year instead of once a month as is currently the case.

Another major demand of service providers is to

widen the net of what constitutes an export. At the moment, providing a service to a foreign client through a branch abroad is not counted as an export of service. The Centre is proposing to amend this to categorise such business as an export.

The proposals are to be discussed at the GST Council meeting and, if approved, will be implemented in a staggered manner to give businesses time to adapt to the new systems.

CONTINUED ON
» [PAGE 10](#)

Spy racket involving 13 Navy staffers busted

Rajulapudi Srinivas
VIJAYAWADA

An espionage racket involving 18 people, including 13 personnel working for the Navy, allegedly shared sensitive information with Pakistani operatives, according to intelligence officials from Andhra Pradesh.

Two of the accused, a civilian driver engaged for Navy officers and a Visakhapatnam Naval Base employee, have been arrested.

Officials said on Tuesday that the Counter Intelligence Cell (CIC) of the Andhra Pradesh Intelligence Department uncovered the racket, which allegedly shared information related to defence establishments, including strategic locations at the Visakhapatnam Naval Base and other parts of the country, with Pakistani intelligence operatives.

Acting on a tip-off, the counter-intelligence police in Vijayawada registered a

The A.P. counter intelligence police have arrested a civilian driver and a Visakhapatnam Naval Base employee

case under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, the Official Secrets Act, and sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, including Section 61(2) (criminal conspiracy).

Under ‘Operation Firewall-2026’, 12 CIC teams were deployed to Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Goa, Delhi, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Bihar and Chhattisgarh. The teams, in coordination with Navy officers, anti-terrorist squads, and the local police, conducted searches and examined the complicity of the 18 suspects, and seized electronic equipment from them.

CONTINUED ON
» [PAGE 10](#)

Houthis deny losing ground, claim Riyadh airport attack

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis on Tuesday denied being pushed back by government forces, who have launched a major operation to recapture lost territory. The group also claimed an attack on the Saudi Arabian capital's main airport on Monday night.

The statements came as Yemen's military said it had removed the pro-Iran group from areas around the Bab el-Mandeb strait, a Red Sea chokepoint, and the port city of Mokha. Houthi fighters “have full control over all their advances on the ground”, the militia's spokesperson said. The opposing claims have been impossible to independently verify, with the situation in Yemen developing fast and access for journalists difficult.

FULL REPORT ON
» [PAGE 14](#)













M BM-BME

NDA wins 34 of 42 seats in Silchar civic election, Cong. gets 2

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led National Democratic Alliance (NDA) won 34 of the 42 seats in the first Silchar Municipal Corporation election in Assam on Tuesday.

The BJP won 32 seats, including two – Wards 9 and 20 – uncontested, while its ally Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) won two seats, according to the results released by the election authorities. The Congress won two seats and independents secured the remaining eight wards.

Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma thanked the people of Silchar for “re-posing their faith” in the BJP and said the outcome reflected the importance they attached to “development, peace, connectivity, empowerment and better governance”.

“The outcome reflects the importance people attach to development, peace, connectivity, empowerment and better governance,” he said. The last civic body election in Silchar was held a decade ago, when the town was governed by a Municipal Board.

‘Very upset’: Conrad Sangma says NPP will recover after four MLAs joins NDPP in Nagaland

Press Trust of India
SHILLONG

Meghalaya Chief Minister and National People's Party (NPP) president Conrad K. Sangma on Tuesday said he was “very upset” after four NPP MLAs in Nagaland merged with the ruling Nationalist Democratic Progressive Party (NDPP), but asserted that the party would overcome the setback and emerge stronger in the State and across the Northeast.

“This is a part of politics. We have seen this many times in different parts of the country and in the Northeast. It is not something that has not happened in the past,” he said while address-



ing NPP workers.

“Are we happy about it? We are not happy about it. We are definitely very upset with this, but we accept that in politics we have to face such situations,” Mr. Sangma said.

Citing similar instances in Arunachal Pradesh and Na-



This is a part of politics. We have seen this many times in different parts of the country and in the Northeast. Even through these difficult and tough times, we must stick together

CONRAD SANGMA
Meghalaya CM

galand in the past, he urged party workers to remain united and committed to the NPP. “Even through these difficult and tough times, we must stick together, and we must work together,” he said. Mr. Sangma said the setback should be used to strengthen the party organisation rather

than weaken its resolve.

“NPP will move forward, we will recover from this and we will come out stronger, not just in the State of Nagaland but in the entire region,” he said. The NPP's four MLAs in Nagaland recently merged with the ruling NDPP, which is also a part of the National Democratic Alliance (NDA), leaving the NPP without a legislator in the Assembly.

“There are different scenarios in different parts of the Northeast. In Meghalaya, being part of the NDA, we have given space to our partners in terms of cabinet berths, whereas in Nagaland it did not happen, though we had given our support,” he said.

M.P.: 8 held for pelting stones during drive against encroachment

Press Trust of India
INDORE

Eight people were arrested after a group of people pelted stones at a team of government officials during an anti-encroachment drive in Indore on Tuesday, a police officer said.

Additional Deputy Commissioner of Police Amarendra Singh said the incident occurred during the removal of illegal constructions along the RE-2 road in Piplyahana.

The removal of encroachments from around 80 houses along the road had been completed, he said.

“During the final phase of the operation, some women and youths gathered at a spot and threw stones at government officials. Police immediately swung into action and drove the people away from the scene,” Mr. Singh said.

Eight people were arrested for stone-pelting, while the police were identifying other accused by reviewing video footage of the incident, he said.



Around 80 houses cleared of encroachments along the RE-2 road in Piplyahana. FILE PHOTO

The situation is currently normal and under control and no one was injured in the incident, Mr. Singh said.

Sub-Divisional Magistrate (SDM) Ghanashyam Dhangar said the district administration, municipal corporation and police jointly carried out the operation at Piplyahana Kankad on the instructions of the District Collector to remove temporary and permanent structures obstructing road construction.

The operation involved clearing 70 to 80 houses, where an equal number of families were residing.

TAMIL NADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
Poonamallee High Road, Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) Admin Building, Koyambedu, Chennai-600 107, Ph.No. (044) 26426773 Email ID : tnpsc.tn@nic.in / CIN/U15137TN1972SGC006157

SHORT E-TENDER CUM REVERSE E-AUCTION / REVERSE BIDDING
RC.No.BS6/023654/2026 Date: 06.10.2026
Short E-Tender Cum Reverse E-Auction / Reverse Bidding
RC. No. BS6/023654/2026- TNCSC/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites online short electronic tender cum electronic reverse auction / reverse bidding for the Purchase of “60,000 Metric Tonnes of Tur dal (Split-Husked & Fatka) (Indigenous)/Tur Dal (Split Husked-Imported) Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Split-Husked & Laird No.2) / Lentil locally known as Canadian Yellow Lentil (Whole-Husked & Laird No.2) for three months of November 2026, December 2026 and January 2027 as per AGMARK specifications”

Complete short e-tender cum reverse e-auction / reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

The bidders have to participate only through online bidding with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III. Last Date and Time for Online Submission: 23.10.2026 up to 11.00 A.M.

DIPR / 3039 / Tender / 2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

ODISHA STATE CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION LTD.,
(A Govt. of Odisha Undertaking)
REGISTERED OFFICE : C/2, NAYAPALLI, BHUBANESWAR-751012
CIN: U51211OR1980SGC000894
Tel No: 0674-3544751, Fax No: 0674-2395291, Website: www.oscsc.in
No.17470 / OSCSC Ltd., Date : 05.10.26

Corrigendum

Ref: Request for Proposal (RFP) Advt. No. 16228/OSCSC Ltd., Date: 17/09/2026
With reference to the RFP issued by OSCSC Ltd. for e-Auction of CMR, the following dates are hereby revised :

Particulars	Existing Date	Revised Date
Last Date of Registration	06.10.2026	12.10.2026
Date of Bidding / e-Auction	08.10.2026 and 09.10.2026	14.10.2026 and 15.10.2026

All other amendments/details of the Corrigendum may be viewed/downloaded from the websites of www.oscsc.in and www.neml.in. All other terms and conditions of the RFP, except those specifically modified through the Corrigendum, shall remain unchanged.

Sd/- Managing Director, OSCSC Ltd.
OIPR-7001/7002/2/26-27/0011

U.T. Administration of Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu,
Department of Fire & Emergency Services, Daman.
TENDER INVITING NOTICE

DFES/DMN/LTN-AMC-NOC/2026-27/342 Dated: 01/10/2026.

Tender Notice No. 02 of 2026-27.

Name of Work: Annual maintenance contract of provisional NOC, Final NOC, and Renewal NOC for the financial year 2026-27.

Start Date of Tender Document: 01/10/2026.

Last date & time of tender submission: 21/10/2026 up to 15:00 hrs. Any Others Details

For Details Please Scan <https://tntenders.gov.in> 0260-2244060

Assistant Director, Fire & Emergency Services, Daman.
NO:IP/DMN/2/5/2026-27/554 dated: 06/10/2026

TAMILNADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
Head Office : Poonamallee High Road, CMRL Admin Building, Koyambedu, Chennai - 600107 Ph.No. (044) 26426773 Email ID : tnpsc.tn@nic.in / CIN:U15137TN1972SGC006157

SHORT E-TENDER CUM E-REVERSE AUCTION/ REVERSE BIDDING NOTICE

Com1/031692/2026 Date:06.10.2026
Short e-Tender cum e-Reverse auction/ Reverse bidding No. : Com1/031692/2026-TNCSC/26-27

Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation invites short electronic tender cum Electronic Reverse Auction for “PURCHASE OF 60,000 MTs. of S Grade Type of sugars for the month of October 2026, November 2026 and December 2026 [Season 2025-26 & 2026-2027]”.

Complete e-Tender cum e-Reverse Auction/ Reverse bidding document can be viewed and downloaded from <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>.

The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III.

Last Date and time for Online Submission : 23.10.2026 upto 10.30 AM

DIPR/3038/Tender/2026 **Managing Director**

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LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE HON'BLE FAMILY COURT AT TRICHIRAPPALLI I.A.NO: 1/2026 IN H.M.O.P.NO:357/2023

P.Senthilkumar, S/o.Late.Palanivelu, No.4/5-361, Kalaivanar theru. AnnaNagar Mela Ampigapuram Trichirappalli City Trichirappalli 620 004. Power Agent Address: P.Sekar, S/o.Late. Palanivelu. The above said address ...Petitioner/Petitioner Vs K.Geetha, Aged 40, D/o.Krishnan, W/o. P.Senthilkumar Flat No:G/04,Maple Adhiraj Gardens, Plot No.32,Sector-5, Kharghar, Navin Mumbai, Raigar, Maharashtra State- 410210,India. ...Respondent /Respondent Notice to Respondent.

The above said Divorce Petition is Posted on 21.10.2026. Hence the Respondent must appear before this Honourable court at 10.30 AM on the same date, or else adverse order will be Passed against the Respondent.

V. SUBRAMANIAN, B.Sc., M.L., Advocate for the Petitioner

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE DISTRICT CONSUMER COMMISSION AT HASSAN

C.C.NO.- 84/2026

COMPLAINANT: SADDAM HUSSIN S/O GOUSE SAHEB, AGE 34 YEARS, NEHARU NAGAR, BELUR TALUK, HASSAN DISTRICT.

VIS

RESPONDENTS: 1) MANAGER, TATA MOTORS FINANCE LTD, 4TH FLOOR, H.C DINNASHAW BUILDING, OFFICE NO. 14, 16 HORNIMAN CIRCLE, FORT MUMBAI-400001. AND OTHERS.

PAPER PUBLICATION

The complainant has filed this application against the respondent for providing a false negative entry to the cibil credit report as a result of which the complainant cibil score has declined and therefore has sought relief. Due to the summons being issued by the hon'ble court to the first defendant in the said trial it has been published in the daily news paper the Hindu that the first defendant should appear before the hon'ble court. Complainant cibil score has collapsed and for that reason they have brought this application against the defendants in the court of the district consumer dispute redressal commission of that place. Those who wish to file their objections should appear in person or through their lawyer in the court on : 02-11-2026 at 10.30. am failing which it will be decided exparte.

Provided on date: 29-09-2026 as per the order of the court.

By Order of the court: Assistant Registrar and Assistant Administrative officer. District consumer Disputes Redressal commission. Advocate for complainant: Ashok kumar K.J. Advocate

EDUCATIONAL

VACANCIES

THE BORVILI EDUCATION SOCIETY'S MATUSHRI PUSHPABEN VINUBHAI VALIA COLLEGE OF COMMERCE
Sheth M. K. High School Complex, Factory Lane, Borvili (W), Mumbai - 400 092

MINORITY AIDED

Applications are invited for the post of **PRINCIPAL** from the Academic Year 2026-27

The advertisement are approved subject to the final decision in the Writ Petition No. 128511 2015.

The above post is open to all however candidates from any category can apply for the posts. Reservation for women will be as per University Circular No.BCC/16/ 74/1998 dated 10 March, 1998. 4% reservation shall be for the persons with disability as per University Circular No. Special Cell/ICC/2019-20/05 dated 05 July, 2019.

Candidates having knowledge of Marathi will be preferred.

*Qualification, Pay Scales and other requirement are as prescribed by the UGC Notification dated 18 July, 2018, Government of Maharashtra Resolution No.Misc2018/C.R.56/18/UNI-1, dated 8 March, 2019 and University circular No. TAASI/CT/ICD/2018-19/1241, dated 26 March, 2019 and revised from time to time *The Government Resolution & Circular are available on the website mu.ac.in

Applicants who are already employed must send their application through proper channel. Applicants are required to account for breaks, if any in their academic career. Application with full details should reach the HON. SECRETARY, THE BORVILI EDUCATION SOCIETY'S. Sheth M. K. High School Complex, Factory Lane, Borvili (W), Mumbai - 400 092, within 15 days from the date of publication of this advertisement. This is an earlier University approved advertisement.

Sd/-
Hon. Secretary

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE TO WHOMSOEVER IT MAY CONCERN

This is to inform the General Public that the following share certificate of **VINATI ORGAINICS LIMITED** having its registered office at B-12 & B13/1, MIDC Indl. Area, Mahad-402309, Dist. Raigad, Maharashtra registered in the name of the following Shareholder has been lost.

Name of the Shareholder	Folio Number	Certificate Number	Distinctive Numbers From - To	No. of Shares	Face Value
M Govindan Kutty	014571	1160	15691671 - 15691920	250	₹2

The Public are hereby cautioned against purchasing or dealing in any way with the above referred share certificate.

Any person who has any claim in respect of the said share certificate should lodge such claim with the Company or its Registrar and Transfer agents- **MUGF INTIME INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED**, C-101, Embassy 247, LBS Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai-400083 Maharashtra TEL:+91 8108116767/Fax:022-49186060 within 15 days of publication of this notice after which no claim will be entertained and the Company shall proceed to issue Duplicate Share Certificate.

Place: Mumbai
Date: 07/10/2026

Name of the Claimant: **Sreerelha J**

Rural Development & Panchayat Raj Department Government of Tamil Nadu

Notification

Rc. No. 1511/2026/A1 Date:06.10.2026

Invitation of Application for the Post of **Director, Social Audit Society of Tamil Nadu (SASTA)**

In accordance with the norms, procedures laid down by Government Order No: (Ms) 94 RD&PR (CGS1) Dept. dated 22.08.22. Application for appointment to the post of Director, SASTA is hereby invited. Application format can be downloaded from website <https://crd-training.in/>

The application in prescribed format should be submitted on or before 29.10.2026 with all enclosures and DD for Rs.500/- drawn in favour of 'The Director, State Institute of Rural Development and Panchayat Raj'.

Director, SIRD&PR, TN

DIPR/ 861 /Display/2026

TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER - II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI-600 008. Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589 / E-mail id :- tasmacsection@gmail.com

e-Tender NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Ltd (TASMAC) invites online tenders/bids in two cover system (Cover I-Financial Bid and Cover II-Financial Bid) for Empanelment of Internal Auditors for District Manager Offices and Retail Vending shops under its control for the period October 2026-March 2027 and extendable for 2 financial years April 2027 to March 2028 and April 2028 to March 2029

TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED
CMDA TOWER - II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI-600 008. Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589 / E-mail id :- tasmacsection@gmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tender Reference No. TASHO/2341/2026-T-1

Sl. No.	Activity	Schedule
1	Commencement of download of the Tender Document.	05.10.2026 at 6.30 PM
2	Pre-Bid Meeting.	08.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M
3	Seek Clarification Start Date	09.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M
4	Seek Clarification End Date	12.10.2026 at 04.00 P.M
5	Bid submission start date	09.10.2026 at 5.00 PM
6	Last date and time for submission of Bids	20.10.2026 at 06.30 PM
7	Opening of Technical Bids	21.10.2026 at 10.00 A.M
8	Opening of Financial Bids	To be communicated to the qualified Bidders

1..The tender document can be downloaded from the portal <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>.

2. Tenderers are advised to follow the instructions provided in the Tender document for the e-submission of the bids through online e-procurement system of Government of Tamil Nadu website. <https://tntenders.gov.in>

Note: If any of the dates mentioned above is declared as Government Holiday or unplanned shutdown by the State, the due date will be postponed to the next working day at the same scheduled time. To enable TASMAC to meet the target dates, bidders are expected to respond promptly to any clarifications requested during the evaluation process. TASMAC will adhere to the above schedule to the best of its ability, but reserves the right to modify it. Notification of any changes will be provided to all bidders.

DIPR/3028/TEN/2026 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation

Vehicle & Mechanical Department

Re-Tender Notice No. :- NMMC/VEH & MECH/ 04/2026-27

Name of work :- Supply of Fully Built VETERINARY AMBULANCE with providing essential medical instruments facilities to cater for any vet emergency and evacuation ON TATA WINGER AMBULANCE 3488WB SHELL AC 10D BS6 Model (01 NO.) & Supply of Fully Built ANIMAL AMBULANCE with providing Rear Lift Trey on FORCE TRAVELLER – T2 DV SHELL 4020 FM2.6CR BS VI– (Qty 01 no.)

Estimated Cost (Rs.) :- 1,37,01,111/-

Tender booklets will be available on e-tendering computer system at <https://mahatenders.gov.in> on dt.07/10/2026 up to dt. 14/10/2026. The tender is to be submitted online at <https://mahatenders.gov.in> For any technical difficulties in the e-tendering process, please contact the help desk number given on this website.

The right to accept or reject any tender is reserved by the Hon'ble Commissioner of Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation sign/-

Deputy Municipal Commissioner (Vehicle & Mech.)
NMMC PR Adv no.844/2026 Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation

Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation
Environment & Climate Change Department
Ch.Eng./Env. & C.C/ 2697 05 OCT 2026

e-TENDER NOTICE

The Commissioner of Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation invite the following online tender:

Name of the Work: Hiring of agency for MER Consulting services for Environment & Climate Change Department.

Bid No. : 2026.MCGM.1342876

Earnest Money Deposit	Tender Scrutiny Fee	Bid Start Date & Time	Bid End Date & Time
Rs.32,100/-	Rs.7,986/- + 18% GST	07.10.2026 11.00 A.M.	16.10.2026 04.00 P.M.

The tender copy can be downloaded from e-Procurement System of Government of Maharashtra (Mahatenders) (<http://mahatenders.gov.in>) also the tender copy can be downloaded from BMC's portal <https://portal.mcgm.gov.in> under "e-tender" section.

PRO/1610/ADV/2026-27 Sd/-
AVOID SELF MEDICATION Executive Engineer(Env. & CC)-II

PUNE BOOK FAIR

INAUGURATION CEREMONY
Wednesday, Dt. 7th October 2026, at 11.00 am

• Venue : New English School Ground, Tilak Road, Pune.

Hon. Prasenjit Fadnavis
Senate Member, Savitribai Phule Pune University

President, Hon. Pramod Rawat
Chairman, Deccan Education Society

Chief Guests

Hon. Adv. Ashok Palande Vice President, Deccan Education Society
Hon. Sachindra Pratap Singh IAS, Education Commissioner Maharashtra
Hon. Yogesh Soman President, Maharashtra Sahitya Parishad

You are kindly requested to attend this program.

Invitees

P. N. R. Rajan Shirish Chitnis
Convener, Pune Book Fair Coordinator, Pune Book Fair

Date	Time	Program
7th October 2026	3.00 pm to 5.00 pm 06.00 pm to 7.00 pm	Poetry & Musical Program Sahitik Gappa (Ravi Mukul / Vinay hardikar)
8th October 2026	11.00 am to 1.00 pm 3.00 pm to 4.00 pm 6.00 pm to 7.00 pm	Author Meet About Cinema - Script Writing Kavi Sammelan (MSP)
9th October 2026	11.00 am to 1.00 pm 3.00 pm to 4.00 pm 6.00 pm to 8.00 pm	Lekhak Aplya Bhetila Author Meet (Hindi) Sahaitya Charcha with Shri. Rajendra Kher (MSP)
10th October 2026	11.00 am to 1.00 pm 3.00 pm to 4.00 pm 6.00 pm to 8.00 pm	Sahitya Charcha Sahitya Charcha Katha Kathan (MSP)
11th October 2026	11.00 am to 1.00 pm 3.00 pm to 4.00 pm 6.00 pm to 8.00 pm	Hindi Hasya Sammelan Sahitya Charcha Musical Program

Organised by **Supported by** **Academic Associate**

Expo Center, Maharashtra Sahitya Akademi, MUCVA, Sahitya Akademi, P. N. R. Rajan, Shirish Chitnis, ASCOP, SURYADATTA GROUP OF INSTITUTIONS

CAPITAL
PROTEST

Opposition MPs from at least 19 parties turned out in full force to demand the scrapping of the SIR of electoral rolls and sacking of CEC Gyanesh Kumar



Cong's Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Rahul Gandhi, K.C. Venugopal; SP chief Akhilesh Yadav, Mamata Trinamool Cong's (MTC) Kalyan Banerjee; Mahua Moitra (MTC), NCP(SP)'s Supriya Sule; A.A. Rahim; and RJD's Manoj Kumar Jha. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA, ANI

INBRIEF

J&K Apni Party leader backs Mufti's 'collective approach' call

Senior J&K Apni Party (JKAP) leader Rafi Ahmad Mir on Tuesday welcomed rival Peoples Democratic Party (PDP) president Mehbooba Mufti's call for a collective approach to address the political aspirations of people in the UT. Mr. Mir, a former PDP legislator from Pahalgam who switched to Altaf Bukhari's JKAP after 2019, said, "I welcome Mehbooba Mufti's call. I have been advocating this for a long time. Jammu and Kashmir cannot afford to speak to Delhi in fragmented voices when the issues before us concern the future of the entire generation." It's rare for JKAP to lend support to the PDP, which saw a vertical split under Mr. Bukhari in 2019.

Seven killed as speeding car rams truck in Bhavnagar

Seven persons died after their car rammed a parked trailer truck on a highway in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district on Tuesday, said the police. The victims were travelling from Bhavnagar to Alang, where they worked at a shipyard, Superintendent of Police Nitesh Pandey said. The accident occurred on the service road along the Bhavnagar-Somnath national highway near Trapaj village in Talaja taluka of the district around 10 a.m. when the speeding car crashed into the stationary trailer, said Mr. Pandey. An investigation into the incident is under way, the officer added.

Badal flags off drive to take feedback for poll manifesto

Press Trust of India
GIDDERBAHA (PUNJAB)

Shiromani Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal on Tuesday launched his party's 'Punjab Bachao' campaign by visiting houses in Doda village in Gidderbaha to elicit suggestions for the party's election manifesto, which he assured would reflect people's voice.

Mr. Badal said people told him that they wanted an end to the drug menace in the State.

The Assembly election in Punjab is likely to be held early next year.

Telling voters that Akali Dal leaders and workers would visit them and take their feedback for the manifesto, Mr. Badal said, "We want to make a *janta* manifesto." He added that manifestos should be given the status of a legal document to ensure that all parties abide by their promises or face disqualification.

CBI books six, including OSD to Mann, in 'corruption' case

FIR registered to investigate allegations of 'influencing' postings of IAS, IPS officers, revenue and property disputes, says probe agency; ED, CBI being misused ahead of Assembly election, says CM

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

A day after the Punjab and Haryana High Court directed the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) to probe corruption allegations linked to Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann's office, the investigating agency on Tuesday registered an FIR and booked six persons, including Rajbir Ghuman, the Officer on Special Duty (OSD) to the CM.

The CBI conducted raids at eight locations, including the CM's camp office. Mr. Mann alleged that Central probe agencies were being misused ahead of the Assembly poll.

The allegations made by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in communications to Punjab Police between July 24 and August 12



Rajbir Ghuman, the OSD to Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann. X/@RAJBIRGHUMANAAP

against public servants and private individuals linked to the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government include corruption in transfers and postings, policy manipulation and cash for tenders.

Those booked are two public servants and alleged middlemen and associates. "The FIR has been registered to investigate the allegations of corruption against the OSD to Punjab CM and his associates for influencing and manipulating postings of officers in-

cluding that of IAS and IPS officers, departmental proceedings, matters pertaining to policy formulation, administrative approvals, tender conditions, licensing matters, land use conversion matters, property disputes, revenue and land related issues in lieu of pecuniary benefits," the CBI stated in a release.

It added that the accused purportedly accessed and provided drafts of orders and policies to private individuals before their issuance. "Extensive coordinated searches were conducted at eight locations across Chandigarh, Mohali, Gurdaspur, Ludhiana, Patiala, Sangrur and Jalandhar at premises connected with the accused persons during which incriminating evidence such as laptops, mobile phones and documents were seized," said the CBI.

In an X post, the CM wrote: "A CBI raid was conducted at my camp office. Now, the ED and CBI will be misused to defame the Punjab government and me. The BJP is rattled by the love being received from the people."

'CBI not sent by Centre' Reacting sharply to his remark, former BJP Punjab chief Sunil Jakhar said, "The CBI has not been sent by the Government of India. It has been ordered by the Hon'ble High Court to investigate the loot of Punjab under your watch."

Punjab's Leader of the Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa said, "The irony is hard to miss: the place that symbolised Delhi's remote control over Punjab is now under the CBI scanner."

SC TO HEAR PUNJAB'S PLEA
» PAGE 10



Amit Shah

Amit Shah likely to visit Manipur in October: CM

Press Trust of India
IMPHAL

Manipur Chief Minister Y. Khemchand Singh on Tuesday said Union Home Minister Amit Shah is likely to visit the State in October, though the "exact date has not been fixed".

Interacting with media-persons after a Cabinet meeting, Mr. Singh said, "We resolved to express heartfelt gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi for completing 25 years in public service and to thank him for his special attention to Manipur and the Northeast."

Bihar CM asks for detailed assessment on flood damage

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Tuesday directed the officials concerned to immediately submit a detailed report on the damage caused by the floods and directed continuous monitoring of the flood-affected regions.

He issued the direction during a review meeting attended by Bharatiya Janata Party national president Nitin Nabin and Deputy CMs Vijay Kumar Choudhary and Bijendra Prasad Yadav, along with senior officials. Mr. Choudhary said the severe flood situation this year arose due to an unprecedented volume of water flowing into the Ganga, Gandak and Son rivers, unlike previous years.

Anti-dam protests: withdraw forces from Siang belt, demands Arunachal youth body

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A tribal youth body in Arunachal Pradesh has asked the government to withdraw the Central Armed Police Forces and State Police personnel deployed to allegedly quell protests against the pre-feasibility report and related surveys for a proposed mega hydropower project.

The All Adi Youth Association condemned the situation arising out of clashes between the protesters and security personnel at various places in Siang and Upper Siang districts over the past few days.

The association's secretary, Okut Taki, told journalists in the State's capital, Itanagar, on Tuesday that the "militarisation" of the Siang river belt has brought law-and-order



Anti-dam protesters say the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project would destroy swathes of wildlife habitats. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

concerns for locals.

Pointing to the protests and frequent clashes, he rejected the Bharatiya Janata Party government's claim that most families who would be affected by the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project favoured the pre-feasibility report.

The National Hydroelectric Power Corporation Limited is pursuing the Siang Upper Multipurpose Pro-

ject, estimated to generate at least 11,000 megawatt (MW) of hydropower.

The Centre and the State government insist that the project would counter the 60,000 MW Medog hydropower station that China is building on the Yarlung Tsangpo, which flows into Arunachal Pradesh as the Siang.

The Siang meets the Dibang and Lohit further

downstream in Assam to form the Brahmaputra.

"The Adis have traditionally resolved disputes through customary institutions such as the Kebang. The deployment of heavy security forces is not the appropriate way to address differences over the project," Mr. Taki said.

'Not all in favour'

The association alleged that the memoranda of understanding the government signed with the villagers "in favour" of the pre-feasibility report did not reflect the views of all 27 villages that will be affected by the project.

Anti-dam protesters say the Siang Upper Multipurpose Project would spell disaster for the Adi community and destroy swathes of forestlands and wildlife habitats.

DMK seeks ECI action against TVK's Dharapuram candidate over 'poll spending violation'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The DMK on Tuesday lodged a complaint with the Election Commission of India (ECI), seeking action against the TVK candidate for Dharapuram, P. Sathyabama, over alleged non-disclosure of election campaign expenditure and violation of the Model Code of Conduct.

DMK MLA S. Austin lodged the complaint with Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik at the Secretariat. In his complaint, he referred to a video in which Ms. Sathyabama was heard saying that "approximately ₹14 lakh was spent on logistics, including hotel accommodation for visiting dignitaries/Ministers, flight tickets for alliance re-



P. Sathyabama

presentatives, and settling amounts related to election coordination/resorts". The video had gone viral on social media platforms.

Mr. Austin urged the ECI to initiate an inquiry by directing the Expenditure Monitoring Cell, the District Election Officer, and the Returning Officer of the Dharapuram Assembly constituency to verify the

day-to-day expenditure registers filed by Ms. Sathyabama.

He also sought verification of whether the account for ₹14 lakh was submitted to the election authorities. If it was found to have been omitted, he sought action against her under the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita for filing "fake expenditure statements".

Ms. Sathyabama was also heard saying in the same video that she had "spent ₹31 crore" on an election. It is unclear whether she was referring to the 2026 Assembly election, in which she was the AIADMK's candidate, or the subsequent byelection, in which she was fielded by the TVK.

Traffic snarls at Delhi's brand-new flyover persist week after opening

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

A week after the Barapullah Phase-III flyover was thrown open with a promise of cutting the journey from Mayur Vihar to AIIMS in Delhi to just 15 minutes, commuters are spending more than an hour inching through traffic on the newly opened corridor. On Tuesday, traffic queues stretching over 2 km brought the 3.5-km stretch to a crawl, with commuters reporting waiting times of 70-100 minutes.

Videos shared by commuters showed vehicles packed bumper-to-bumper on the elevated road, with even ambulances



Traffic queues stretching over 2 km brought the 3.5-km stretch to a crawl. FILE PHOTO

caught in the snarl.

"I have been stuck on the flyover for the past 25 minutes in a traffic jam," a commuter travelling from Noida towards New Delhi told *The Hindu* around 10.30 a.m. When contacted an hour later, the commuter said they were still stuck in the traffic and that

it had taken more than 70 minutes to get off the flyover.

Another commuter described the stretch as "completely blocked", saying traffic had remained stationary for nearly an hour and questioning the absence of traffic personnel on that particular stretch.

Meanwhile, the Public Works Department (PWD) on Tuesday placed jersey barriers at the merger point, a police officer said.

"The jersey barriers, which are concrete or plastic road dividers used to channel vehicles, are aimed at preventing vehicles from joining the existing corridor at an abrupt

angle, allowing traffic to merge more smoothly and reducing the sudden slowing that has been contributing to the bottleneck," the officer said.

The traffic police also deployed personnel at the merger point to manually regulate the flow, allowing traffic from each side to pass one stream at a time to ease the bottleneck, he added.

Redesign sought

In a letter dated October 1, the Delhi traffic police asked the PWD to modify the merger near Sundial Park. The letter was based on a joint inspection conducted by senior traffic police officers and PWD of-

ficials on September 30 to examine traffic movement and the geometry of the new flyover and its adjoining stretches.

The traffic police found that the new flyover joins the existing corridor through a relatively sharp, almost rectangular alignment rather than a gradual curve. This forces traffic to merge abruptly and creates a bottleneck at the junction.

The issue was already evident within days of the flyover opening. Barapullah Phase-III was opened to public traffic on September 29 and by the following evenings, queues had stretched up to 3.5 km.

"Travelling to Bhikaji

Cama Place from Ghaziabad was a nightmare. Traffic was stuck on the new Barapullah flyover for more than 30 minutes in the morning," a commuter said. Suggesting that congestion could be reduced by discouraging unnecessary traffic, the commuter said the stretch could even be made a toll road.

Traffic pattern

The traffic police have also written to Google seeking an update of the traffic pattern on the new road. South Delhi Deputy Commissioner of Police (Traffic) Sandeep Gupta said the company had sought seven to 10 days to incorporate sufficient traffic data.

Maharashtra Cabinet clears higher allowances for SC, ST students

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Maharashtra Cabinet on Tuesday approved a number of proposals, including higher allowances under scholarship and hostel schemes for students from Scheduled Caste (SC) and Scheduled Tribe (ST) communities.

Under the Bharat Ratna Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Swadhar Yojana, students from SC and Navbuddha categories who are eligible for government hostels but did not get admission will now receive a total annual

grant of ₹80,000, up from ₹60,000.

The revised amount applies to those pursuing higher education in Mumbai City, Mumbai Suburb, Pune, Pimpri-Chinchwad, Navi Mumbai, Thane and Nagpur.

A similar hike has been cleared for students from ST communities under the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyay Swayam Yojana.

The Cabinet also approved the Mukhyamantri Shaurya Padak for police personnel for acts of bravery and a compensation policy for custodial deaths.

INBRIEF



Karnataka to launch drive to close defunct borewells

Karnataka will launch a Statewide campaign to identify and close defunct and unsafe open borewells, Minor Irrigation Minister Ajay Dharam Singh said in Bengaluru on Tuesday. The ‘Borewell Suraksha Abhiyan’ will initially focus on defunct borewells drilled under the Minor Irrigation Department, and will later cover borewells under other departments and those in public places. “Not a single borewell should become a threat to a child’s life,” he said.

Man gets 47-year jail term for sexually assaulting minor

A special court in Kerala on Tuesday sentenced a 43-year-old man to 47 years of rigorous imprisonment for sexually assaulting a 15-year-old boy, who is his relative and neighbour. Special Judge Anju Meera Birla of the Thiruvananthapuram Fast Track Special Court also slapped a fine of ₹32,000 on the convict. The court said that he must undergo an additional three years and three months of imprisonment if he fails to pay the fine.

₹7 lakh stolen from ATM in Hyderabad; search continues

Around ₹7 lakh was stolen from an Axis Bank ATM at Satamrai in Shamshabad area of Hyderabad, Telangana, on Tuesday. According to the police, the burglary is suspected to have taken place between 3 a.m. and 3.30 a.m. Two suspects are said to have sprayed paint on the ATM’s CCTV camera and then committed the theft. The police are examining CCTV footage from the surrounding area to identify the suspects and trace their movements.

UDF govt. implementing BJP agenda, says Pinarayi

The Hindu Bureau KOZHIKODE

Leader of the Opposition in the Keralam Assembly and CPI(M) leader Pinarayi Vijayan has accused the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government in the State of implementing the agenda of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and its political arm, the BJP. He was delivering a speech to inaugurate the two-day extended Kozhikode district committee meeting of the party on Tuesday. He said the latest example was its decision to weaken the State Planning Board.

Panel revamp widens rift in Keralam film artistes’ grouping

G. Krishnakumar KOCHI

The rift within the Association of Malayalam Movie Artistes (AMMA) has widened following a recent decision by the executive committee to fill the vacant posts of vice-presidents, treasurer and joint secretary. Actors Asha Aravind and Sijoy Varghese were made vice-presidents by the committee last week. Actors Neena Kurup and Sarayu Mohan were elected treasurer and joint secretary, respectively. The 17-member panel, led by its first woman president Shweta Menon, had announced its resignation

Act against illegal resorts in Karnataka tiger reserves, Minister to forest officials

The Hindu Bureau BENGALURU

Environment Minister Ramalinga Reddy has directed forest officials to take immediate action against all illegally established resorts and homestays in the eco-sensitive zone (ESZ) and buffer zone of various tiger reserves and protected areas of Karnataka. Mr. Reddy, who chaired a meeting of the Standing Committee of the State Board for Wildlife, sought details on the number of resorts, homestays and other commercial activities in the ESZ and buffer zone after the ESZ was notified for various tiger reserves and protected areas.



The Minister has sought details on the number of homestays, resorts and commercial activities in the eco-sensitive zone.

He also directed that there should be minimal disturbance in ESZ areas and that they should be declared as silent zones. He also sought preparation for Zonal Master Plans to create awareness among

people on the dos and don’ts in ESZ areas.

No quarrying A proposal for allowing quarrying activities in the ESZ of Kappatagudda Wildlife Sanctuary in Gadag

was rejected. The proposals for electrification BSNL saturation towers, OFC cables and a small connecting bridge were approved for recommendation to the Standing Committee of the National Board for Wildlife (SC NBWL).

At the meeting, it was also decided to submit a proposal to the SC NBWL for rationalisation of the boundary of the Shettihalli Wildlife Sanctuary where the boundary was not properly demarcated while notifying it. The Standing Committee of the State Board for Wildlife also decided not to alter the eco-sensitive zone of the Bannerughatta National Park.



PITHAMPUR AUTO CLUSTER
(A Government of M.P. Undertaking-Subsidiary of MPIDC)
1st Floor, Atulya IT Park, Khandwa Road, Indore-452001 (M.P.)
website: www.pithampurautocluster.com, Email: md.pacl@gmail.com
No. PAC/IND/2026-27/170
Date : 06.10.2026

INVITES PROPOSAL
for
O&M Contract for Operation, Maintenance & Management of Tool Room & Technical Service Centre



Pithampur Auto Cluster (PAC) had developed a Tool Room & Technical Service Centre facilities in the year 2009 at 113/2-A, Harniakhedi, A.B. Road, Opp. Veterinary College, Tehsil-Mhow, Distt. Indore (M.P.) with total initial investment of Rs. 47.40 crores, spread on 5 acres’ land. Since inception these facilities are being Operated & Managed by M/s Indo Toolings Pvt. Ltd. (A unit of M/s JMB Auto Ltd., Gurgaon). As the current O&M Contract is going to be expired, PAC is looking for an entity capable to take the responsibility to Operate, Maintain and Manage the Tool Room and Technical Service Centre facilities on “as is where is basis” for the period of 15 years. The complete details of the proposal may be seen at e-portal <https://mptenders.gov.in>. The last date of submission of proposal is 29.10.2026. The document can be purchased online from 08.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.

For any further information/clarification you may contact CFO, PAC (Mob: 9424011969).

M.P. Madhyam/128406/2026

MANAGING DIRECTOR

Surya, India’ first indigenous fleet support ship, launched

It is a floating supply powerhouse that can sustain protracted, high-intensity naval engagements; Rajnath urges Indian shipyards to look beyond self-reliance and aim at international markets

V. Kamalakara Rao VISAKHAPATNAM

Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh launched the Navy’s first indigenous Fleet Support Ship (FSS-1), named *Surya*, and laid the keel for the fifth vessel of the series, FSS-5, at Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL) in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday.

The ceremony was attended by Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, Secretary (Defence Production) Sanjeev Kumar, Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Eastern Naval Command



Homemade vessel: Rajnath Singh speaking at the launch of the fleet support ship, *Surya*, in Visakhapatnam on Tuesday. V. RAJU

Vice Admiral Sanjay Bhalla, HSL CMD Rear Admiral C. Raghuram, and other dignitaries

The Minister urged Indian shipyards to look beyond self-reliance towards global competitiveness, aiming to serve inter-

national markets, build a presence in marine technology, and provide advanced ship repair services.

The massive Fleet Support Ship (FSS) initiative is backed by a landmark ₹19,000-crore contract

between the Ministry of Defence and HSL to construct five indigenous auxiliary vessels.

The FSS platform, with 82% indigenous content, serves as a floating supply powerhouse, engineered to sustain protracted, high-intensity naval engagements and battle groups far from home ports.

Its internal storage holds up to 20,000 tonnes of high-speed diesel, 2,500 tonnes of aviation turbine fuel, fresh water, alongside dry cargo containers for ammunition and spares. It can simultaneously transfer fuel, stores, and personnel to multiple warships to maintain continuous high-seas deployment.

Form 7 filings linked to BJP, says Owaisi

The Hindu Bureau HYDERABAD

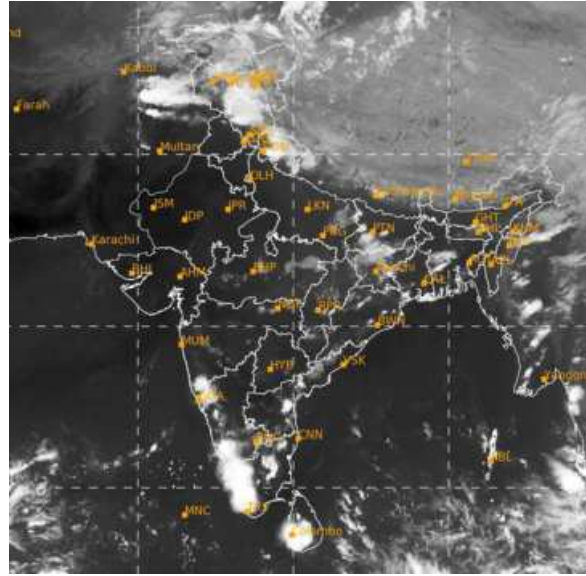
Hyderabad MP Asaduddin Owaisi on Tuesday alleged that numerous pre-filled Form 7 applications seeking deletion of voters names from the electoral rolls were submitted in the Goshamahal Assembly constituency, a segment which is a part of the Hyderabad Lok Sabha seat, and sought action against the individual who submitted

the forms in bulk.

Citing a specific example, Mr. Owaisi said 122 Form 7 applications had been submitted at Booth 28 in Goshamahal. He said they were part of a deliberate exercise to remove voters belonging to a minority community. Noting that the forms were “pre-printed”, he said his enquiries revealed that the person who submitted them was one Janardhan, a “BJP supporter or sympathiser”.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



Forecast for Wednesday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Chandigarh, Delhi, Bihar, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Kerala and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	0.4	33.6	25.2	Kurnool	37.3	26.6	
Ahmedabad	36.4	25.4		Lucknow	33.0	22.5	
Aizawl	31.2	19.8		Madurai	37.3	26.1	
Bengaluru	42.6	26.8	19.6	Mangaluru	6.3	31.9	24.0
Bhopal	36.1	19.0		Mumbai	33.5	24.8	
Bhubaneswar	35.4	24.4		Mysuru	24	31.8	19.8
Chandigarh	34.8	24.6		New Delhi	36.8	25.2	
Chennai	5.4	36.0	25.4	Patna	33.0	25.9	
Coimbatore	34.5	23.6		Port Blair	3	31.5	24.8
Dehradun	2.8	30.3	21.3	Prayagraj	34.2	23.8	
Gangtok	3.8	20.6	15.0	Puducherry	34.9	26.3	
Goa	32.6	24.5		Pune	36.6	22.2	
Guwahati	32.4	24.4		Raipur	34.8	24.5	
Hubballi	33.0	21.0		Ranchi	30.6	20.0	
Hyderabad	34.0	20.8		Shillong	23.2	15.2	
Imphal	30.9	19.3		Shimla	26.7	16.7	
Jaipur	36.6	25.6		Srinagar	24.6	14.0	
Kochi	0.8	32.2	25.2	Thiruvananthapuram	34.5	25.1	
Kohima	21.0	15.1		Tiruchirappalli	37.5	26.4	
Kolkata	34.5	26.8		Vijayawada	3	33.5	25.0
Kozhikode	36.1	26.5		Visakhapatnam	1	33.2	24.7

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	77	41	20	117	194	■	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 238 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 20
Bengaluru	28	32	80	43	76	■	
Chennai	5	11	18	81	86	■	
Delhi	8	68	13	229	267	■	
Hyderabad	11	20	54	77	113	■	
Kolkata	9	58	38	248	154	■	
Lucknow	6	27	29	76	78	■	
Mumbai	3	47	40	96	116	■	
Pune	5	61	57	91	94	■	
Visakhapatnam	17	68	21	65	121	■	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_x: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease



Government of Karnataka
KARNATAKA EXAMINATIONS AUTHORITY
Sample Road, 18th Cross, Malleshwaram, Bangalore-560 012 Phone: 080-23 460 460 (5 Lines)
e-mail: keauthority-ka@nic.in Website: <http://kea.kar.nic.in>

No. ED/KEA/ADMN/PGNEET MD-MS /CR-12/2026
NOTIFICATION
PGET-2026 - Admission to Post Graduate Medical courses for the year 2026-27 in the state of Karnataka & admission to In-Service seats of DNB (Primary and Secondary) and Diploma (NBEMS)

- KEA is inviting applications online for admissions to PG Medical courses from the eligible candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 for the year 2026-27 for the available PG Medical Degree / Diploma courses in Government Medical colleges, Government Quota seats in Private and Minority Medical Colleges and Private seats in Private Medical colleges (KPCF, KRLMPCA, AMPCK and Private Universities) located in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
- As per Government order No., HFW 882 HSH 2021 Bangalore Dated 10-01-2022, KEA is also inviting application online from the eligible Karnataka in-service candidates who have qualified in NEET-PG-2026 and desirous of applying DNB / Diploma Courses in the State of Karnataka for the academic year 2026-27.
- The candidates who have obtained more than or equal to the prescribed minimum 50th percentile in NEET PG 2026 only are eligible to register and apply online for PG Medical courses for the year 2026-27.
- Non-Karnataka candidates will not be eligible for reservation. Hence, in the NEET-PG 2026 examination, if they have scored the required minimum 50th percentile or above, fixed for ‘GENERAL (UR)’ category as per the qualifying criteria, then only they are eligible to register for admissions through KEA or for any other seats in the State of Karnataka. Please note that SC/ST/OBC eligibility criteria are applicable to Karnataka SC/ST/OBC candidates only.
- Interested and eligible candidates can register, apply online and pay the fees for admission to Karnataka PG Medical Degree and Diploma courses from **11.00 am on 05-10-2026 up to 11.00 am on 15-10-2026**.
- Afterwards, as per PGNEET-2026 ANNEXURE-18-19, candidates have to appear for verification at KEA, Bangalore by booking the slot. (Hosted in the KEA Website)
- Registration fee, details of document verification, original documents to be submitted for document verification, and other details have been published on the KEA Website. Interested and eligible candidates can register by selecting the specified link on the KEA Website apply online and appear for document verification on the specified dates as per their eligibility.
- Information Bulletin-2026 detailing admission eligibility criteria and other details are hosted on the KEA Website <https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgtmed2026> for the information of the candidates. Before registering through online for admission to PG Medical courses in the state of Karnataka, applicants are hereby informed to read the Information Bulletin PGNEET-2026 and understand the eligibility conditions, educational qualification, classification of seats (different types of category of seats), procedure for conduct of online seat allotment and eligibility to claim such seats.
- Mere qualifying in NEET-PG 2026 does not confer any right on the candidate for admission unless the candidate fulfils eligibility conditions / submits the documents / certificates. Further, only the candidates who complete the registration process including document verification are eligible for PG Medical seats in Government / Private Colleges in Karnataka.
- For more details please visit KEA Website <https://cetonline.karnataka.gov.in/KEA/pgtmed2026>

NOTE: As per NMC, New Delhi letter dated 24-07-2023; all the rounds of counselling including Stray Vacancy Round will be conducted only by KEA in online mode, all the PG NEET qualified candidates are hereby advised to register online and complete the document verification process in KEA to become eligible for admission to PG Medical Courses in the State of Karnataka.

Sd/-
(H. Prasanna, IAS),
Executive Director.

DIPR/CP/JA/3092/2026-27

CM YK 18 BM-BME



Let there be light

The Nobel Laureates for Medicine illuminated how the brain works

The first of the Nobel announcements has come, heralding the season of celebrating the fruits of the perennial human endeavour to know more and use that knowledge to benefit people. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine went jointly to Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegeman and Georg Nagel “for their discoveries concerning light-gated ion channels and optogenetics”. True to Alfred Bernhard Nobel’s aim of annually recognising those who have “conferred the greatest benefit to humankind”, this year’s Nobel went to people who shone a light, literally, on the brain, providing a quantum leap in understanding how it functions. In essence, if the brain is a puppeteer pulling the strings, the body is the marionette. The dexterity of the puppeteer is obvious, but her methods, often not. It is this that the Nobel trio sought to explain with optogenetics – making it possible to show how nerve cells communicate with each other, and the body, regulating memory, emotions and bodily functions. It allowed mapping the brain in ways that were previously impossible. As most often in work that the Nobel acknowledges and honours, there was rich collaboration across continents in advancing optogenetics. Peter Hegemann wondered what enabled *Chlamydomonas*, a single-celled alga, to swim towards a light source; Georg Nagel went on to discover an algal protein that can be illuminated with blue light to open a channel within, allowing charged ions to flow into the cell and create electrical impulses. Karl Deisseroth transformed the protein into a light-controlled switch for nerve cells. Practically, today, scientists use harmless viral agents to deliver genes for light-sensitive proteins into specific target cells. Then they deliver precise pulses of light, activating the channels, allowing research to study the patterns. In the decades since the laureates described their work, researchers have gone on to use optogenetics to reveal neural circuits governing specific memories, feelings and behaviours relevant to neurological and psychiatric disorders. It laid the groundwork for clinical treatments targeting conditions including Alzheimer’s and addiction. Researchers are even using the method in attempts to restore sight.

As technology facilitates easier pathways to translating scientific research that happens in labs into practical therapies, diagnostics and health-care practices that could ameliorate human health or protect it from illness, it is also important for nations to find ways to ensure that the fruits of such research actually reach all the people who might benefit from it, irrespective of their location or station in life.

Break the chain

India must focus on cutting transmission of leprosy

While the prevalence of leprosy among adults and children and the grade-2 disability rate have dropped in India over the last decade, its continued transmission in many pockets constrains India’s ability to meet targets outlined in the National Strategic Plan (NSP) and Roadmap for Leprosy 2023-2027. By 2005, the national prevalence had dropped to under 1 case per 10,000 people, prompting the World Health Organization (WHO) to declare that India had “eliminated [leprosy] as a public health problem”. However, the government became complacent and allowed the folding of the leprosy surveillance programme into the general health system. Multi-drug treatment regimens also shortened the time for which patients remained formally registered, allowing prevalence to fall and transmission to continue. Disability due to leprosy began to rise in the early 2010s, prompting door-to-door screening. Today, the NSP is right to focus on cutting transmission, in line with WHO. Since India’s children accounted for around 46% of all cases reported among children in 2025, the two programmes need to move in tandem. The drop in disease burden has also been highly uneven – Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, and Maharashtra bear disproportionate shares of the national burden. According to the 2025-26 National Leprosy Elimination Programme report, only 148 districts have achieved ‘interruption of transmission’ (pending field verification) against the projected 300.

In 2025-26, workers screened more than 70 crore people in highly endemic areas, where 24,367 cases were detected, and ASHA workers flagged nearly 40 lakh suspected cases, with 48,027 cases confirmed. Workers also administered single-dose rifampicin as post-exposure prophylaxis to 91.1% of those 16.9 lakh likely to have come in contact. The government has operationalised digital surveillance and is deliberating on using the MIP vaccine to accelerate pathogen clearance in patients deemed highly infectious. One persistent set of lacunae pertains to care: research has shown nerve damage in many patients by the time they sought care, largely due to the stigma, while many clinical practitioners are unfamiliar with leprosy’s pathology or misdiagnose it as a skin condition. Reading these realities together, the state should double down on interrupting transmission and make prevalence a secondary outcome. It should also resist the temptation to ease detection or revise its elimination targets – the 2025-26 report says the overall incidence overshot projections by 41%, incidence among children by 91.6%, and the grade-2 disability rate by 34% – and instead redouble its investments to meet the extant 2026-27 projections. Finally, it should commit its augmented efforts at locations and social settings where both late diagnosis and transmission remain trenchant.

In my 48 years in public life, I have seen political parties rise and fall. I have seen leaders emerge with great promise and fade away. I have seen governments change, economies transform and technology alter our lives beyond recognition. One lesson has become increasingly clear to me: ultimately, leadership matters.

In today’s world, technology, knowledge, capital and ideas are freely available. But the true differentiator for nations is leadership – one with vision, integrity, credibility and the ability to execute.

On October 7, 2026, Prime Minister Narendra Modi completes 25 uninterrupted years in executive office – first as Chief Minister of Gujarat and, since 2014, as the Prime Minister of India. It is a remarkable journey of leadership sustained by public trust. Through changing circumstances, Mr. Modi has remained remarkably consistent in his purpose: the development of India and the empowerment of its people.

The world around us has been turbulent. We have witnessed a global financial crisis, a once-in-a-century pandemic, wars, geopolitical realignments, technological disruption and economic uncertainty. Several democracies have experienced frequent changes of leadership and consequent policy uncertainty. Through all this, India has remained steady at the wheel and an oasis of economic hope.

Leadership built on trust

Such stable leadership cannot sustain itself for 25 years merely through politics. It requires trust. Mr. Modi has earned that trust through an established track record, impeccable personal integrity and tireless self-discipline. In today’s world, public leaders effectively live in glass houses. Every decision and every action can be seen and questioned. To retain the confidence of people over decades under such scrutiny is an achievement in itself.

Mr. Modi brings a unique ability to understand people’s aspirations, translate them into action and communicate those results back to the people.

The results are visible. Over the last decade, India’s National Highway network has expanded from about 91,287 kilometres in 2014 to more than 1,46,000 km. The airport network has grown from 74 airports in 2014 to over 160. Railway electrification has accelerated dramatically. India’s installed renewable-energy capacity has now reached nearly 296 GW,



N. Chandrababu Naidu

The Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years in leadership reflect India’s transformation and its rising national ambitions

The China-U.S. rapprochement

The world, understandably, has been watching carefully the unfolding summitry between the United States and Chinese Presidents over the last several months. It had been a long time between drinks: just under a decade in the case of President Donald Trump’s last visit to Beijing in late 2017; and just over a decade since President Xi Jinping stood on the White House lawns in 2015 with President Barack Obama.

Whereas now it is four summits in little more than six months: Beijing, Washington, Shenzhen and then Miami. Now it is everything, everywhere, all at once, with some speculating that we are seeing the birth of a new G-2.

More a new phase

It is natural for the world to wonder what, if anything, has fundamentally changed in the strategic architecture of the U.S.-China relationship. It is always hard to parse the difference between the language and theatre of politics and diplomacy, and what is actually happening on the ground.

Despite the pomp and circumstance in both the Beijing and Washington summits, the reality is that nothing much has changed in the fundamentals of the relationship. Whatever public language might be used, the U.S. and China remain fully engaged in an all-pervasive strategic competition on which of them will emerge as the dominant Indo-Pacific and then global power for the 21st century – militarily, in the economy, technology, foreign policy as well as the underlying ideological contest between democratic capitalism and China’s alternative authoritarian model.

Whatever the diplomatic surround sound might be, core decision-makers in both Washington and Beijing continue to have a deeply realist view of this ongoing strategic contest – or what the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) has long called the “struggle for the future of the international order”. Strategic competition is not going away. The real question is whether that competition can be managed within the framework of some mutually acceptable rules of the road. Or whether it is left unmanaged with a rolling risk of crisis, conflict or even war.

What the U.S. and China appear to be doing is moving towards an imperfect form of bilateral management mechanism. This process began in



Kevin Rudd

Global President and CEO of Asia Society, New York, and the 26th Prime Minister of Australia

There is no ‘G-2’ yet in U.S.-China relations -- Washington and Beijing may manage their tensions, but their strategic competition remains entrenched

including large hydro, with solar alone crossing 168 GW. Infrastructure today is being conceived not as isolated projects but as an integrated national network through initiatives such as PM Gati Shakti (Prime Minister Gati Shakti – National Master Plan for Multi-Modal Connectivity).

At the same time, India’s welfare architecture has expanded basic security and dignity. Around 80 crore people receive free foodgrains, including five kilograms a person per month for eligible priority households. Tapwater coverage in rural homes has risen from about 17% in 2019 to over 82%. An estimated 24.8 crore Indians moved out of multidimensional poverty between 2013-14 and 2022-23. The significance lies not only in the scale of these programmes, but in their reach. Technology has enabled the State to deliver basic entitlements more directly, transparently and at a scale that was once unimaginable.

Technology in nation-building

Mr. Modi has a deep appreciation of technology and its role in transforming India. He understands emerging technologies, adopts them early and, more importantly, applies them to nation-building. He sees technology as a tool to improve governance, empower people, create opportunities and accelerate development. India’s Digital Public Infrastructure has shown how technology can democratise access to banking, welfare and public services at unprecedented scale. This deep appreciation of technology has enabled him to launch a host of frontier policies aimed at making India take a giant leap and put it in the league of global tech titans. India’s quantum mission, semi-conductor mission, and a host of Production Linked Incentive (PLI) schemes across electronics and advanced manufacturing are instances of this vision.

India’s space sector is another great example. For decades, India’s extraordinary capabilities in space were centred overwhelmingly around government. By opening the sector to private enterprise and creating an enabling ecosystem, the government has unleashed a new generation of entrepreneurs. Companies such as Skyroot Aerospace, Pixxel, Agnikul, Dhruva and Bellatrix demonstrate what young Indians can achieve when regulation gives way to innovation.

As a Chief Minister first and then a Prime Minister, Mr. Modi has a strong belief in “Team India”. He knows that India cannot be transformed from Delhi alone. Growth needs to be decentralised with States and cities

competing. His emphasis on cooperative and competitive federalism has given States a larger role in India’s development journey.

India’s place in the world

In his tenure, India’s stature abroad has also changed profoundly. Today, India’s voice is heard with greater respect on global platforms. India protects its national interest while engaging with different centres of global power, preserves strategic autonomy while building deeper partnerships, and projects its civilisational confidence as a modern, technology-driven nation. India today is among the world’s fastest-growing major economies. But I believe the most consequential phase of our journey is still ahead.

Few countries possess India’s combination of strengths. It has a demographic dividend, an extraordinary entrepreneurial energy, technological capabilities and a young generation that is ambitious, confident and increasingly connected to global opportunity. If we make the right decisions now, the benefits will last for centuries. This is why leadership at this moment assumes historic importance.

Mr. Modi’s 25 years in executive leadership have demonstrated the qualities such a moment demands. The Narendra Modi who became Chief Minister of Gujarat on October 7, 2001, and the Prime Minister leading India today are connected by the same clarity of purpose and unshakeable belief in India’s potential.

Twenty-five years have established his record. The next 20 years can establish India’s place in history. The true significance of these 25 years, however, will be judged by what they enable India to achieve next. Mr. Modi has shifted the country’s development trajectory – from incrementalism to ambition, from hesitation to confidence, and from managing limitations to believing in possibilities. I am confident that the direction he has set and the institutional momentum created during these years will help India realise its ambition of Viksit Bharat 2047 and reclaim its place among the world’s leading nations.

Few leaders are given the opportunity to shape a generation. Rarer still are those who can shape the destiny of a nation. After 25 years of leadership, Mr. Modi’s greatest contribution may ultimately be that he made India believe once again in the scale of its own possibilities – and gave the nation the leadership to turn that belief into reality.

Washington Summits. But the U.S. has added the explicit caveat that any such bilateral framework be both “fair and reciprocal”.

For Washington realists, that is enough to drive a bus through any “constructive strategic stability” narrative on any day of the week. Furthermore, Beijing would be wildly optimistic if it concluded that Donald Trump is likely to be constrained in his future freedom of manoeuvre because of some grand, overarching foreign policy narrative. The President just does not operate that way.

A fragile truce

What concerns China most is if what is called the “Busan Tariff Truce” agreed to last October falls apart. That original 12-month truce has only been extended two months. If the U.S. concludes that China has not been helpful on U.S. agricultural exports, or in the normalisation of the critical minerals and rare earths trade with the U.S., there is a real risk that the Busan Truce collapses. And if the European Union were to move in the same direction on tariffs given the crisis in European manufacturing, the consequences for an export-dependent Chinese economy would be large.

For all these reasons, both tactical and strategic, the U.S.-China relationship remains deeply fragile. Even if the Busan Truce extends beyond December, the effective general U.S. tariff rate against China will remain much, much higher than, for example, India’s. Beyond trade, there also remains a formidable array of export controls on critical technologies, including world-class chips where China remains several years behind the U.S. And that leaves to one side a bilateral foreign investment regime which remains deeply restrictive at both ends of the relationship.

Therefore, breathless reporting about an emerging “G2” between the U.S. and China in some sort of global strategic condominium is fanciful. Whatever tactical accommodations may occur in the trade relationship, the fundamental nature of the strategic competition between Washington and Beijing continues. Remember it was Donald Trump, on the very eve of Mr. Xi’s state visit to Washington DC, who stated, “Whoever wins in AI, wins.” That is Xi Jinping’s view too. That does not exactly sound like an emerging G-2 to me.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Transparency, poll trust

The Supreme Court of India’s notice to the Election Commission of India over the “modified” Form 6 highlights a simple point: any change to voter registration must follow due legal procedure and be made public. Citizens providing correct details

should be able to register without hurdles. Transparency in the Election Commission is essential to restoring public trust.

Sankalp Gupta,
Dhenkanal, Odisha

The Changes concerning voter registration and electoral rolls cannot be

treated as routine administrative matters when they directly affect citizens’ democratic rights. The Election Commission must ensure that every decision is transparent, accountable and supported by clear records. At the same time, allegations must be examined on the basis of

evidence rather than assumption. Public confidence in elections ultimately depends on institutions being open to scrutiny.

Albin Thekkethala,
Kallur, Thrissur, Kerala

Medicine Nobel
Many of the most significant

advances in medicine start with questions that appear to have nothing to do with the field. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine is a striking instance. This is something that India should take note of. Basic science requires patience, freedom, and continuous support — a

question which seems unclear in a laboratory at the present time could end up forming the basis of tomorrow’s medicine.

Dr. Yash Javeri,
Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address and the full name.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

India's data centre sector investment commitments

173 in \$ billion. India's data centre (DC) market added about 130 MW of new capacity in the first six months of 2026, while more than 200 MW is expected to go live in the second half of the year, CBRE said in a report released on Tuesday. Hyperscale and co-location investments accounted for close to 62% of the cumulative DC commitments. PTI

Amount Zambia will sign in U.S. five-year health deal

3.6 in \$ billion. Zambia will sign a revised health agreement with the U.S. that will not include contentious clauses committing the African nation to share data with the U.S. government. The U.S. has signed new bilateral health agreements with around two dozen African nations since last year, but some have pushed back on requirements to provide patient data. PTI

Indian crew members injured in ship hit by projectile in Hormuz

11 Eleven Indian crew members were injured on Tuesday after a Panama-flagged commercial vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz. The vessel, *MT On Peace*, carried 19 crew members, including 17 Indian nationals. The Ministry of External Affairs said continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region remain a "cause of deep concern" for India. PTI

Ukrainian drones downed overnight, according to Russia

900 Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday. Unconfirmed reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. PTI

Students who received bicycles under Delhi's Vidya Vahini Yojana

18,000 Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Tuesday distributed bicycles to 581 Class 9 girl students under the government's Vidya Vahini Yojana, aimed at making the daily commute to school easier and promoting independence among girls. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The status of U.S. blockade on Cuba

U.S. blockade and decades-old embargo on Cuba have worsened the island's economic and humanitarian crisis, with fuel shortages disrupting electricity, food distribution, healthcare; as Havana seeks to ease the crisis, Trump administration's pressure and demand for regime change continue to constrain Cuba's options

WORLD INSIGHT

Srinivasan Ramani
Sambavi Parthasarathy

The story so far:

It has been nearly nine months since the U.S. President Donald Trump signed an executive order threatening tariffs on any country that supplies Cuba with oil, and the U.S. Coast Guard began intercepting tankers and ships bound for the island. Power cuts in Cuba have since become very common, often lasting beyond 12 hours a day and even close to 20 hours in some provinces. Independent UN human rights experts condemned these actions, calling them “energy starvation” and an “unlawful blockade” of the island country, as the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights reported. In July 2026, the UN General Assembly voted 136-9 (with 30 abstentions) to debate the blockade despite U.S. objections. Mr. Trump, meanwhile, has threatened a takeover of the island nation – a threat that is unlawful according to the UN Charter, which prohibits “the threat or use of force” against a country’s political independence. The new blockade is over and above a 64-year-old embargo by the U.S.

Embargo or blockade?

Following the 1959 Cuban revolution, the Cuban government led by Fidel Castro nationalised U.S.-owned property in 1959-60. The U.S. responded, imposing a partial “embargo” on Cuban trade in October 1960 and making it full-fledged in 1962. Cuba terms the measures *el bloqueo*, or a blockade, as it goes beyond mere bilateral trade and is exemplified by further measures taken by the U.S. on Cuban foreign trade. The Cuban Democracy Act of 1992 barred foreign subsidiaries of U.S. firms from trading in Cuba, and the Helms-Burton Act of 1996 wrote the embargo into law, so that only the U.S. Congress can lift it. It also allowed lawsuits against foreign firms using property in Cuba that was confiscated from the Americans.

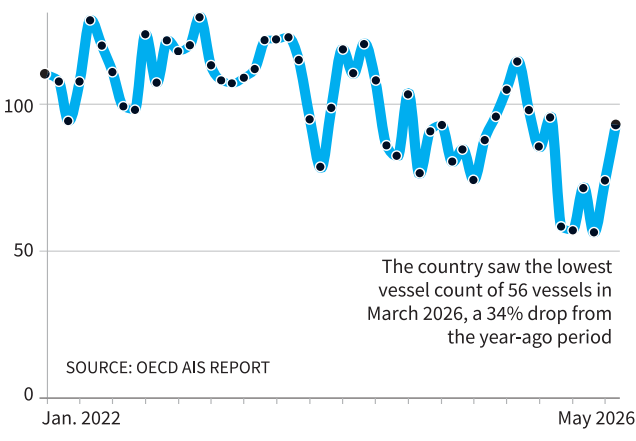
After coming to power, Mr. Trump expanded further on these punitive measures by bringing Cuba back on the State Sponsors of Terrorism list (without any justification after it was briefly removed by the outgoing Biden administration in January 2025). This has meant that banks find it difficult to deal with Cuban entities. In May, the Trump administration imposed secondary sanctions on foreign firms dealing with the Cuban state and its military conglomerate, GAESA. It has also indicted former Cuban President Raul Castro on problematic charges, besides the January 29 order, which declared a national emergency and authorised extra duties on goods from any country that sells or provides oil to Cuba.

Year after year in the UN General Assembly, since 1992, there has been near-unanimous demand to end the “embargo”, but the resolutions are not binding, and this has allowed the U.S. to continue it. Havana claims that the cumulative damage of the embargo has been to the tune of \$178.7 billion and \$8.08 billion in the year up to February 2026 itself, which includes just one month of the fuel blockade. These costs are not just lost U.S. trade, but also the impact on Cuba’s overall trade because of what the embargo imposes. For example, ships docking in Cuba are barred from

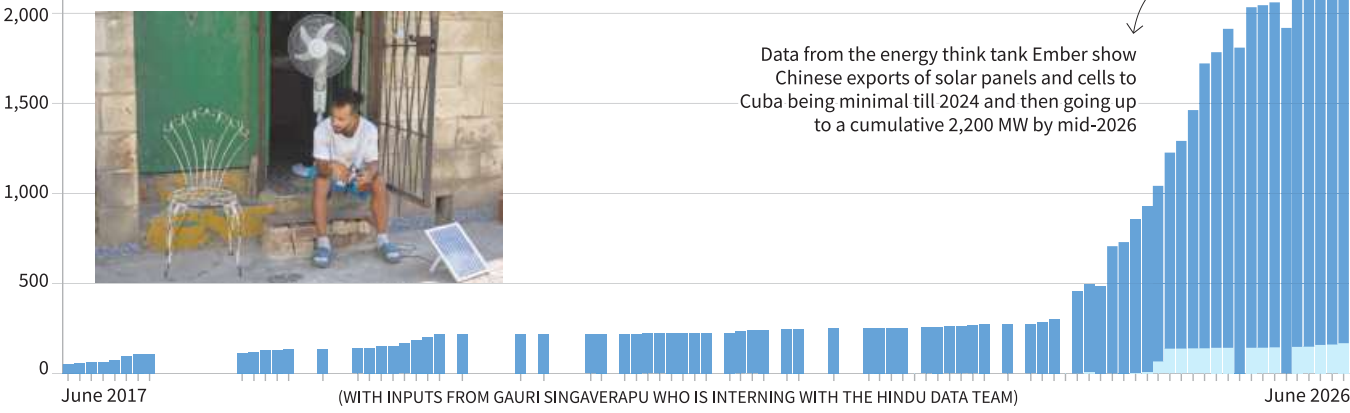
Fragile lifelines

Fewer ships and disrupted trade underline growing pressure on Cuba's economy

The chart shows the number of vessels en route to Cuba



The chart shows the export of solar panels and cells to Cuba (in capacity)



U.S. ports for 180 days, which has led to increased freight costs. With the U.S. imposing financial sanctions, banks refuse Cuban payments, and imports of medical equipment and machinery have also been affected.

Has this hostility against Cuba always been the case?

U.S. policy towards Cuba has been motivated largely by the lobbying efforts of Cuban exiles based in Miami, Florida, who fled the island following the Revolution. These hardliners include those born to Cuban-immigrant parents, such as current Secretary of State Marco Rubio, who have sought the collapse of the communist system in Cuba. They have also strongly backed the Trump administration's actions, as making conditions that are “ripe for regime change”, according to the International Crisis Group.

The hostility against Cuba experienced a brief thaw during former President Barack Obama's second tenure. In December 2014, he and Raul Castro announced a normalisation of ties, which led to embassies reopening, Cuba being taken off the terrorism list, and culminating in a visit to Havana by Mr Obama. Travel and remittance rules were eased, but the embargo still stayed. Mr. Trump reverted much of it during his first tenure before imposing stronger restrictions in his second tenure, which intensified after U.S. forces attacked Venezuela and abducted its president, Nicolas Maduro and took control over the Latin American country's fuel and energy resources since then.

Why was Venezuela an important lifeline for Cuba?

Following the collapse of the Soviet Union, which affected the Cuban economy severely, leading to what was called a “special period”, Fidel Castro and Hugo Chavez signed an “oil-for-services” agreement in 2000. This led to the Barrio Adentro health missions (neighbourhood medical services) provided by Cuban

doctors in Venezuela. Some 40,000 Cuban doctors, teachers and other professionals worked in Venezuela, while the country supplied about 1,00,000 barrels of oil a day on relatively easy terms. Cuba also resold some of the oil for hard currency, according to U.S. officials, to mitigate the impact of the U.S. financial sanctions.

Meanwhile, mismanagement of the state oil company PDVSA, the 2014 crash in oil prices and later U.S. sanctions cut Venezuela's oil output to a third by the late 2010s, leading to lowered shipments to Cuba. The imports met, by late 2025, only about a quarter of Cuban demand for oil and about a third of its oil imports.

In January 2026, that came to naught too after the U.S. took control of Venezuela's oil sector. Mexico, which had supplied about 44% of Cuba's oil imports, then suspended deliveries. Russia has not been able to step up and fill in the gap either, with just sporadic ships managing to deliver supplies to Cuba since the naval blockade.

What was the impact of the fuel blockade?

The International Crisis Group lists “severe disruption to transportation, food distribution, health care, water systems and communications” in the country. On May 7, three UN Special Rapporteurs said fuel scarcity was keeping people from hospitals and children from school. They cited a backlog of more than 96,000 surgeries, 11,000 of them for children, and delays in infant immunisation.

The scale of the impact is shown in satellite imagery data. An index of night-time light intensity built from NASA satellite data, a proxy for electricity use, fell from about 10-12 in 2021-25 to around six by mid-2026. Ships reaching Cuba have been reduced from 100-120 a month to just 50-60 in early 2026 and oil cargoes have become sporadic. The impact of the sanctions has also meant a large drop in employment in industries such as tourism – which the Cuban government sought to utilise to shore up its dollar reserves –

and mining and shipping. The naval blockade has also occurred at a time when one in five Cubans have emigrated in the past five years due to the weak economy.

How is China helping Cuba mitigate the fuel shortage?

On September 23, President Miguel Diaz-Canel said that Cuba has installed 1,418 MW of solar capacity in 144 parks and would pass 1,500 MW by the end of 2026. He said that renewables already generate 21.4% of the country's electricity. Much of the equipment for these installations have arrived from China. Data from the energy think tank Ember show Chinese exports of solar panels and cells to Cuba being minimal till 2024 and then going up to a cumulative 2,200 MW by mid-2026. In September, reports showed that a third batch of 5,000 standalone solar systems donated by China arrived for public buildings and isolated homes, after shipments in August and November 2025. But power blackouts persist because solar power is not generated after sunset, when demand peaks and battery storage is inadequate in Cuba. The power grid also relies on aging oil-fired plants.

Chinese customs data also show China's imports from Cuba rising from about \$50 million in 2015 to \$320 million in 2022, with commodities such as zinc ores, nickel products, lead and silver ores, lobsters, cigars and rum. But this trade fell to \$230 million in 2025 and \$145 million roughly in 2026 so far.

What other reforms has Havana embarked upon?

Havana approved 176 reforms in June to expand private enterprise and foreign investment, but the blockade continues to stymie these. Back-channel talks with the Trump administration have continued but there is little progress because the latter demands regime change while Havana insists that it “will not compromise on its sovereignty or political constitution”, according to ICG.

THE GIST

The U.S. has tightened pressure on Cuba through secondary sanctions, restrictions on foreign firms and a fuel blockade, building on the 64-year-old embargo that has raised trade, shipping and financial costs for Havana

Venezuela's oil-for-services arrangement had long been a crucial lifeline for Cuba, but falling Venezuelan production, U.S. intervention and the suspension of Mexican supplies have left the island struggling to meet its fuel needs

Cuba is turning to Chinese-backed solar power and reforms to private enterprise and foreign investment to cope, but inadequate battery storage, an ageing power grid and continued sanctions have limited their impact

Why growing trust in digital payments may be leaving Indians more exposed to cybercrime

UPI has become a more trusted and frequently used mode of payment in India; but SPIR 2026 finds a paradox, people who trusted online banking the most and used UPI most often were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime; report shows how fraud networks exploit this trust through deceptive schemes, fake apps and ‘digital arrest’

Vinson Prakash

At a roadside tea stall, the QR code neatly taped on the can of biscuits now does more work than the cash box. A scan, a password, and a reassuring beep. No change to count, no note to fumble. In a country where your vegetable vendor, the auto driver and the doctor all get paid the same way, digital payments, especially UPI, have become a site where one’s bread and butter are bought and sold.

The scale is hard to overstate. UPI has processed over 24,000 crore transactions in FY 2025-26, with the transaction values crossing ₹314 lakh crore. As the world’s most populous country, India has 70% of its population connected to the internet, making it one of the most sought-after global markets for internet services and digital platforms. That vast, eager, and active user base is also a tempting target. One that is ripe to be picked on by cybercriminals. The Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026 shows how the two meet: how India uses the internet and how cybercriminals stay one step ahead of users.

Digital payments are a daily habit for Indians. About half (49%) of the respondents use UPI apps every day, while another quarter (24%) use them once or twice a week. UPI also stood out as the most frequently used online payment method, with almost half (48%) saying they use it “many times”, ahead of card, wallet, and NEFT/RTGS payment methods (Table 1).

Trust follows usage. UPI garnered the most trust out of all payment

The trust test

UPI dominates online payments, but the SPIR 2026 data shows that high trust and frequent use can coexist with greater exposure to cybercrime

Table 1: UPI is the most frequently used for of online payment

Online payment modes	Frequency of use		
	Many times	Sometimes	Never
UPI	48	30	19
Debit/credit card payment	20	40	33
Payment wallets	14	25	49
NEFT/RTGS	7	23	57

Note: All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond. The categories ‘never’ and ‘I don’t make online payments’ are merged to form the ‘never’ category.

Question asked: When making payments online, how frequently do you use the following a) UPI b) NEFT/RTGS c) Debit/credit card payment d) Payment wallets – many times, sometimes, or never?



Table 2: Those who consider online banking to be safe are more likely to be victims of cybercrime

Index of perceived safety of various modes of online banking	Have you been a victim of a cybercrime or helped the victim closely in cyber complaint registration/handling the issue?	
	Yes	No
Very safe	28	65
Somewhat safe	26	70
Somewhat unsafe	22	73
Very unsafe	14	80

Note: All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond.

Question asked: Have you been a victim of a cybercrime in the last 2-3 years; or did you help the victim closely in registering the cyber complaint or in handling the overall issue?

Question asked: In your opinion, how safe are these modes of online banking: a) UPI b) Mobile banking apps c) Internet banking websites d) Debit/credit card payments g) Wallet-based apps – very safe, somewhat safe, somewhat unsafe, or very unsafe?

methods, with a third (34%) of the respondents considering it “very safe” and two in five (41%) considering it “somewhat safe”, meaning three in four people consider it to be safe. Card payments came in second, with about two in three (65%) considering it safe – 28% considering it ‘very safe’ and 37% ‘somewhat safe’ – followed by wallet-based apps and mobile banking

apps. Taking all online banking modes together, a majority of the respondents find them to be safe, with about a quarter (23%) finding them “very safe” and about two in five (40%) finding them “somewhat safe”.

On its own, this is a success story. People trust a system they use constantly, and the system mostly delivers.

The trust paradox

SPIR also asked a different set of questions about behaviour, which together measure how vulnerable a person is to unsafe online practices. Would they open a link from an unverified sender? A photo, video, or file from a stranger? Share an OTP with an unknown caller? And so on.

When trust is set beside vulnerability, the pattern is striking. The people most prone to unsafe online practices were also the most confident about online banking. Among the highly vulnerable, about half (49%) called online banking modes “very safe” and another 39% considered them “somewhat safe”. Among those with moderate to no vulnerability, only about a fifth, on average, considered online banking to be “very safe”.

Following this thread towards victimisation, it was found that those who considered online banking modes as “very safe” were also more likely to have been victims of cybercrimes in the past 2-3 years. Among victims, 28% considered online banking modes to be “very safe” compared with 14% who considered online banking modes ‘very unsafe’ (Table 2). As perceptions of safety decreased, so did their likelihood of being a victim.

Usage tells the same story. Those who use UPI “many times” were more likely to have been victims of cybercrime in the last 2-3 years, compared to those who “never” use it.

People’s high trust and usage of online banking methods is being met with an adversary that is organised and inventive. A cybercrime expert in the report described a supply chain

that sells fraudsters “kits” of pre-activated SIM cards, bank accounts, and cell phones. For a small investment of ₹10,000-20,000 in these kits, the fraudsters can swindle someone’s life savings worth tens of lakhs or crores, and remain largely untraceable. The interviewed victims further shed light on the various inventive schemes cybercriminals use to defraud people. The fraudsters create entire investment/betting apps, convincingly hold victims under digital arrest for several days, and gain victims’ trust and convince them to share personal information.

The deception does not stop at victims. Two people interviewed for the report, both accused of perpetrating cybercrime, said they had lent their bank accounts to fraudsters who deceived them, leaving them part of a crime they did not fully understand. Fraudsters are not only exploiting gaps in the financial system, but they are recruiting its users and leaving them to be apprehended by the police as the most replaceable link in the chain, while they themselves go untouched.

The SPIR 2026 points to an almost paradoxical association: the more people use digital payments, the more they trust them, and the more likely they are to be victims of cybercrime. But that is only one half of the picture. The other half is a sophisticated adversary who is armed with the right tools, exploits the trust people have in their financial systems, and quite tactfully plays on the human psyche to deceive their victims.

(Vinson Prakash is a researcher at Common Cause)

Cyber fraud victims dissatisfied with banks over delayed action and poor recovery support: study

13% of respondents experienced cybercrime in the past two to three years, with 54% of victims reporting digital financial fraud; while most victims approached banks within 24 hours, many reported delays in blocking unauthorised transactions, poor support and banks’ reluctance to accept liability; victims, experts also raised several concerns

Radhika Jha

Cybercrimes have disrupted our conventional understanding of both how crimes take place and how the systems responding to them function. While there is much to be said about the non-financial cybercrimes that may be just as prevalent as financial cybercrimes, the latter have captured the public’s imagination and fears in unprecedented ways.

A recent study by Common Cause and Lokniti, CSDS, the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) 2026: Cybercrimes – Victim Perspectives and Systemic Responses, brings out the perspectives of the common public, victims, and domain experts on this issue, focusing on how victims navigate through the complex systems. The study is based on a survey of 8,306 respondents from across 16 States/U.T.s, along with in-depth interviews with 37 stakeholders, including victims, cybercrime experts, and others.

In financial cybercrime cases, the banking sector becomes an integral part of the reporting and resolution process, widening the traditional understanding of the core criminal justice institutions such as the police and courts. In this context, the study explores, among other things, whether banks as an institution are prepared to deal with these cases and to take accountability for security lapses.

According to the survey data, 13% of the overall respondents were victims of cybercrimes in the last 2-3 years. Among the victims, more than half (54%) were victims of digital financial frauds.

One of the first actions taken by the victim after the incident was complaining directly to the banks. More than half of the victims of digital financial fraud (52%) who were surveyed said that they had complained to the bank separately after the incident. A majority, 63%, complained within the first 24 hours.

Banks’ response

Despite the promptness in reporting shown by many victims, the response by the banks leaves much to be

Banking on banks

Table 1: More than half of all cybercrimes involve digital financial frauds

Nature of crime	Victims
Digital financial frauds	54
Hacking of devices	13
Personal data theft	11
Cyberbullying/abuse on social media	7
Online sexual harassment	4

Note: The rest did not respond or reported facing other types of crime. All figures are in percentages

Question: What type of crime did you face?

Table 2: Nearly two out of three respondents reported the fraud to the bank within 24 hours

Time taken to report the fraud after it occurred	Victims/respondents who assisted victims of cybercrimes (%)
Within 24 hours	63
Within 48 hours	21
More than 48 hours	11

Note: The rest did not respond.

Question asked: How soon after the fraud did you/they report it- within 24 hours, within 48 hours, more than 48 hours?

desired. A 2017 RBI guideline states that in cases of third-party breach due to no deficiency by either the bank or the customer, and if the customer notifies the bank within three days, the loss must be borne by the bank entirely. This was extended on a pilot basis in 2026 to include those cases wherein the customer had been tricked or coerced into making scam payments, with limited liability being placed on the bank in such cases.

In-depth interviews with victims revealed, however, that the banks’ response to cybercrimes is almost entirely focused on evading accountability and liability. The standard response from the banks in cases of digital financial fraud is that the victim “collaborated” with the perpetrator of the cybercrime. All the victims of digital financial cybercrimes who were interviewed qualitatively, barring one, said that the bank maintained this in their case, even in cases where the victims did not interact with the perpetrators at any point. Notably, the one case in which the banks did not give this response included a high net-worth individual

Victims often report fraud quickly, but face delays and poor support when seeking recovery

Table 3: Two-fifths of the victims who complained separately to the bank feel that crime occurred due to a breach of personal data

Complained made separately to the bank (among victim)	Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data	No, it didn’t happen because of the breach of personal data
Yes	40	44
No	26	54

Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages.

Question asked: Some victims of financial cybercrimes believe that their financial data was leaked by a bank insider because of which they were targeted by criminals. In your case, do you think the crime occurred due to a breach of your personal data by the bank or its personnel?

Statement 1: Yes, it occurred due to a breach of personal data; Statement 2: No, it didn’t happen because of that.

Table 4: Nearly a quarter of the victims of cyber fraud are very dissatisfied with the bank’s role in recovery of money

	Degree of satisfaction			
	Very satisfied	Somewhat satisfied	Somewhat dissatisfied	Very dissatisfied
The bank’s role in recovering the money	11	21	16	22

Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages. The table includes responses from both the victims and those who assisted cybercrime victims of digital financial fraud.

Question asked: How satisfied were you with the following – very satisfied, somewhat satisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, or very dissatisfied?

with a long-standing relationship with the bank.

Low satisfaction

Vipin (name changed), a Gurgaon-based journalist, got a scam call for SIM upgradation on a Saturday. The caller, pretending to be an Airtel employee, shared some of his personal information to appear legitimate, including his name, date of birth, Aadhaar number, and debit card number. Despite cutting the call, ₹5,000 was withdrawn from a payment wallet linked to his number the following day. He immediately blocked his number and emailed his bank, since it was closed on Sunday. However, by Monday afternoon, his account had still not been blocked, and the fraudsters had taken a loan of ₹5 lakhs against his credit card, half of which had already been withdrawn. The bank, however, took “zero accountability” for this loss and was “apathetic” to the complaint, as reported by him.

Other victims reported similar instances of delays by the banks in stopping the flow of unauthorised

transactions immediately following the complaint. While the banks become directly liable for such losses when presented with such evidence of negligence in taking prompt action, there is little accountability for the mental, physical and financial costs to the victim in the recovery process necessitated by such negligence

Data (in)security

A more serious allegation levelled against the banks, both by cybercrime experts as well as victims, is that of complicity in the cybercrimes, whether directly or indirectly. The survey data shows that amongst victims who complained to the bank separately, as many as 40% were of the opinion that the cybercrime occurred due to their financial data being leaked by a bank insider. Amongst those who did not complain to the bank separately, 26% hold this opinion. Overall, while a significant proportion of the victims feel that the breach of their personal data enabled the cybercrime incident, this sentiment is amplified amongst those who had first-hand experience with the bank in

dealing with their case.

In-depth interviews with victims made similar grave allegations against the banks. Of the 13 digital financial fraud victims interviewed, five victims were of the opinion that bank officials were directly or indirectly complicit in the crime. One of the victims was told by the police officer investigating her case that the bank must be complicit, though no charges were filed against it.

Cybercrime experts and senior police officers dealing with these cases strongly supported this perception. They further stressed the lack of accountability for the common leakages of customer data, due to inadequate security systems.

Another major systemic loophole is the lack of due diligence by banks when opening bank accounts, which can be used as mule accounts in cybercrime cases. Policing and cybercrime experts were of the opinion that banks prioritise their business interests over building secure systems. “People like you and me will lose access to our accounts due to KYC procedures, but these accounts [the cyber criminals’] will never be closed”, stated a former police officer.

Satisfaction with the banks

Overall, the levels of satisfaction with the banks remained low across the victims of digital financial cybercrimes, as is emerging both from the survey data as well as the in-depth interviews with victims. More than one out of five victims of digital financial fraud surveyed reported being “very dissatisfied” with the bank’s role in recovering money, while 16% said that they were somewhat dissatisfied.

Amongst the in-depth interview respondents, the satisfaction levels were lower, with the victims rating the banks a poor one out of five. Even in cases where the victims were able to recover their money fully or partially, the satisfaction with the banks remained low. Notably, there was not much variation in the reported experience or satisfaction levels across private and public-sector banks. (Radhika Jha is Project Lead (Rule of Law) at Common Cause and lead researcher and author of the Status of Policing in India Report (SPIR) series. Views expressed are personal)

From Page One

Rahul calls SIR ‘treason’;
INDIA MPs detained

Delhi Police had barricaded all roads leading to Parliament amidst heavy security deployment. Around noon, the Delhi Police began bundling the leaders into buses, clearing the site.

Mr. Akhilesh and Mr. Banerjee, along with other prominent Opposition leaders, Mr. O’ Brien and John Brittas, were detained and taken to the Parliament Street police station, where Samajwadi Party workers protested for about an hour.

At this point, Mr. Gandhi and a few other Congress leaders squeezed past private security personnel posted at the gates of Akashvani Bhawan to enter the building.

He said Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, and Mr. Kumar have “destroyed” the country’s democracy.

The National Students’ Union of India and Youth Congress activists briefly barged through the gates of Akashvani Bhawan, storming the precincts. Delhi Police sent out buses to detain these activists. Despite senior Delhi Police officials’ multiple efforts to negotiate through the impasse, Mr. Gandhi and other senior leaders refused to leave.

Centre moots 5-pronged
reform plan for GST

At the moment, 61% of taxpayers receive their GST registration within three working days without the need for a tax officer’s involvement, an official in the Finance Ministry said. The Centre will now propose a streamlining of processes for the remaining taxpayers so as to avoid “unnecessary queries” and avoid rejections.

Further, the Centre will propose an upgrade of the existing invoice management system to match invoices in such a manner that corrections and changes made to an invoice by the seller are recorded at each step and automatically reflected in the buyer’s invoice.

“This would avoid a large number of notices issued to taxpayers due to invoice mismatches,” the official explained.

At the moment, businesses complain that their input tax credits are often held up from being credited to their accounts because their suppliers have not filed their returns. The Centre is now trying to address this issue.

Further, the Centre is proposing that ordinary business costs, that currently do not get refunded as ITC, should be brought into the ITC system. In addition, taxes paid on input services, earlier not eligible for ITC, will be proposed to be made eligible.

Refunds are also proposed to be acknowledged within 10 days, with 90% of the refund amount to be released on the basis of a ‘risk check’ using data obtained automatically from the Customs department and the banking system.

The Centre will also propose classifying testing, repair, certification, and research done in India for a client abroad to be classified as an export of services even if the goods stay within the country.

“For example, companies might send cars to India to be tested, which are then destroyed after the testing and not sent back,” the official explained. “That will now count towards services exports as far as tax treatment is concerned.”

Another proposal that could significantly reduce paperwork for small businesses is the one regarding where they are registered.

The Centre will propose that sellers be allowed to register once in their home State and, once verification is done, be granted access to sell in the rest of the country.

Spy racket involving 13
Navy staffers busted

One of those arrested in connection with the case, Annam Sai Vara Prasad, a contract driver engaged for Naval officers, was picked up in Visakhapatnam. He is accused of having shared key information related to the Visakhapatnam Naval Base in return for money.

Another accused, identified as Pradeep Mukherjee, a naval employee at the Visakhapatnam Naval Base, was arrested in Coimbatore earlier. He is accused of having shared an OTP for the activation of a WhatsApp account for a Pakistani intelligence operative and of having passed on sensitive information relating to defence establishments.

Both men were produced in court on Monday, after which they were sent to Visakhapatnam Jail under judicial custody until October 14.

According to investigators, women intelligence operatives from Pakistan are suspected of having approached the accused using fake profiles on various social media sites. A source said, “The alleged approach involved false professional identities, misleading promises, sexually explicit content, and monetary inducements intended to draw personnel into sharing sensitive defence information. The information sought reportedly included the movement and number of naval ships and submarines, photographs and videos of naval assets, and sensitive establishments, photographs and details of Commanding Officers. The material also describes attempts to persuade personnel to show sensitive areas of naval establishments, ships and submarines during video calls.”

The accused were also allegedly offered monetary incentives, through cryptocurrency or intermediaries, to share OTPs required to activate WhatsApp accounts to contact more targets.

Bypolls held in five Assembly
segments, one Lok Sabha seat

Highest voter turnout of 86% in T.N.’s Madurantakam seat; West Bengal CEO got 97 official complaints on polling day; Congress seeks cancellation of Bengal bypolls due to ‘booth capturing’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Bypolls were held on Tuesday in five Assembly seats in Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, and Puducherry, and one Lok Sabha seat in Assam. The Madurantakam Assembly constituency in Tamil Nadu recorded the highest polling percentage of 86%.

The other Assembly seat which went to the polls in Tamil Nadu was Dharapuram, which saw a turnout of just over 80%. Both seats in the State were reserved for Scheduled Caste candidates.

The byelections to these two seats were necessitated by the resignations of Magaratham Kumaravel from Madurantakam (SC) and P. Sathyabama from Dharapuram (SC), who both won on All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) tickets in the 2026 State election and subsequently switched to the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) after resigning their Assembly memberships within three weeks in May 2026.

In Puducherry, where the bypoll was held in the Thattanchavady Assembly



A young mother casts her vote during the bypoll in Assam’s Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency on Tuesday. RITU RAJ KONWAR

segment, there was 80.8% voting. The election was caused by the resignation of AINRC chief and Chief Minister N. Rangasamy, who retained the Mangalam Assembly seat.

In West Bengal, where bypolls were held in the Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly seats, there was a voter turnout of almost 80%, despite the fact that many were not able to vote as their inclusion in the electoral roll is under appeal in Appellate Tribunals.

Voter polling trends till 5:30 p.m. showed Nandigram at 79.4% and Rejinagar at 78.4%. West Bengal’s Chief Electoral Officer received 97 official complaints through designated

portals on the polling day.

The bypolls were needed as West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari won two seats and then vacated Nandigram to retain Bhabanipur, where he had defeated former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee. The Aam Janata Unnayan Party (AJUP) MLA Humayun Kabir, had also won in both Rejinagar and Nowda in Murshidabad, later giving up the Rejinagar seat.

Poll irregularities

Nearly 19,000 members of the electorate from these two seats who could not vote in the last Assembly election were also unable to exercise their franchise in the bypolls. Their names were put under adjudica-

SC to hear Punjab’s plea against
CBI probe linked to CM’s office

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday agreed to urgently hear the Punjab government against a State High Court order directing the Central Bureau of Investigation to register a case and probe allegations of corruption against the office of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann.

Appearing before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, senior advocates Vikas Singh and Shadan Farasat, for the State government, said the order violated the very basic principles of federalism. Mr. Singh said the State was poll-bound, and a Central agency has been ordered to investigate allegations.

Mr. Singh said the alle-



Bhagwant Mann

gations regard administrative matters but the High Court has ordered a criminal case to be registered.

The Chief Justice said the court would endeavour to list the case for hearing in the next 24 hours or definitely hear it on October 8. The High Court had, on October 5, directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations linked to Chief Minister Mann’s office. The alle-

gations raised by the Enforcement Directorate against individuals linked to the Aam Aadmi Party government include corruption in transfers and postings, policy manipulation, cash for tenders, and other serious irregularities.

CBI probe

Pronouncing its order on a public interest litigation case, a Division Bench said that, on a cumulative assessment of the material placed on record in the petition, the court was of the view that a fair and transparent investigation was required into the issue.

Expressing dissatisfaction with the Punjab Police’s handling of the case, the High Court entrusted the probe to the CBI.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Three new Supreme Court judges took oath on Tuesday, raising the working strength to 37 even as case pendency hovers near one lakh. Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant administered the oath of office to Justices Sunita Agarwal, Devendra Kumar Upadhyay and Aparesh Kumar Singh at the Supreme Court.

The three judges were sworn in a day after the Centre notified their appointments. The Supreme Court Collegium had recommended their names to the government on September 28.

The appointment of the new judges has increased the number of working

‘Provisional Census
data is likely to be
out by March-April’

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI



Amit Sharma

The provisional data for Population Census 2027 will be available by March or April next year, according to Amit Sharma, Chief Principal Census Officer and Director of Census Operations for Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

Ladakh became the first of India’s Union Territories and States to complete the entire Census exercise, ahead of the rest of the country where the exercise is scheduled to finish in February 2027. This is the first digital Census and the first in independent India to enumerate caste, other than Scheduled Castes and Tribes.

Advance enumeration

Other than Ladakh, the second phase or Population Enumeration (PE) phase also concluded in the snow-bound areas of Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, and Jammu and Kashmir on September 30, with a revisional round from October 1 to 5.

On September 5, the PE phase was advanced in the poll-bound States of Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, Uttarakhand, and Goa, scheduled to take place from November 16, 2026 to January 4,

2027, ahead of the nationwide enumeration planned for February 2027. The Union government also formally deferred the Census exercise in conflict-ridden Manipur “till further declaration,” Mr. Sharma said.

Snow-bound areas

Mr. Sharma said that provisional data from the PE phase shows that 5,292 enumeration blocks have been covered in the designated snow-bound areas of J&K (4,597 blocks) and Ladakh (695 blocks).

The snow-bound enumeration was preceded by a self-enumeration window from August 17 to 31, followed by field enumeration from September 1 to 30.

Mr. Sharma said the completion of the exercise was an important operational milestone and involved specialised arrangements because of the difficult terrain and climatic conditions.

Supreme Court gets three new
judges, strength goes up to 37



CJI Surya Kant administers oath of office to newly appointed SC judge Sunita Agarwal during a swearing-in ceremony. PTI

judges in the apex court to one short of its sanctioned judicial strength of 38, including the CJI.

Justice Agarwal was serving as the Gujarat High Court Chief Justice before her appointment to the Supreme Court. The parent High Court of the judge is Allahabad. Justice Upadhyay’s parent High Court is

also Allahabad though he was serving as the Delhi High Court Chief Justice at the time of his recommendation.

Justice Aparesh Kumar Singh, whose parent High Court is Jharkhand, was serving as Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court before being appointed to the Supreme Court.

Man held over
fake video
of Delhi ACP
with woman

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police have arrested an ‘independent journalist’ for creating and circulating a fabricated video that allegedly falsely portrayed Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Vivek Bhagat in an objectionable situation with a woman.

This comes a day after 17 protesters, including a woman journalist who had accused Mr. Bhagat of sexually harassing her during the October 3 protest in Delhi, were arrested by the Delhi Police. The Parliament Street police had booked the protesters on charges of unlawful assembly.

Police said the fabricated video was circulated through an Instagram account. The account was traced to 24-year-old Naadeem Ahmed Ameen, who has been arrested.

Privilege vs free speech case in
SC disposed of after two decades

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

After a pendency of well over 20 years in the Supreme Court, a seven-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant took less than half-an-hour on Tuesday to dispose of as infructuous a reference related to questions linked to legislative privilege being used to choke free speech, arising out of a 2003 Tamil Nadu Assembly resolution to arrest editors of *The Hindu* for an editorial criticising then Chief Minister Jayalalithaa.

The Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant found no point in going for lengthy hearings after learning from the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly counsel, senior advocate Raju Ramachandran, that the resolution against the newspaper had been withdrawn in 2004.

The Constitution Bench

The seven-judge
Bench disposed of
the long-pending
reference in less
than half-an-hour

said the withdrawal of the resolution escaped the notice of the Supreme Court.

On the petitioners’ suggestion, the Court left the larger and substantial questions of law open for a future occasion in an appropriate case.

On October 5, the very eve of the Constitution Bench hearing, Mr. Ramachandran, backed by Attorney General of India R. Venkataramani and Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, had brought the fact of the withdrawal to the attention of Chief Justice of India.

Mr. Ramachandran had submitted that the fact of the withdrawal was not noticed by the court nor recorded in its order referring the case to the seven-

judge Bench a couple of months ago in August. He had said the reference would only be an academic exercise now.

Chief Justice Kant had said the court did not want to get into a prolonged academic exercise, particularly when several other unheard matters were pending.

The case goes back to 2003 when *The Hindu* had published the editorial, prompting the Assembly Speaker at the time to pass a resolution in the House accusing the daily of having “distorted the proceedings of the Assembly, commented contrary to the events in the Assembly”.

The resolution had said the comments made in the editorial “amounts to breach of privilege of the entire House” under Article 194 of the Constitution, which guarantees freedom of speech and immunities to Members of State legislatures.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Defence Ministry on Tuesday signed a ₹661.50-crore contract with BrahMos Aerospace Private Limited (BAPL) for procurement of BrahMos Fire Control Systems and launchers for Indian Navy ships, aimed at strengthening the Navy’s maritime strike capability and advancing defence indigenisation.

The Ministry said the

contract, signed in New Delhi in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh, has been placed under the Buy (Indian-IDDMM) category, with a minimum of 68% indigenous content.

The project is expected to encourage greater participation of the Indian defence industry, including micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs), and generate employment over a period of three years, the Ministry said.



APPEAL

Baby Jeevith Sai is 1 year old advised to undergo Intra Cardiac Repair Surgery at Public Health Centre, Chennai. The surgery cost is **Rs.2,00,000/-**. Baby’s father deserted the family. Mother finds it very difficult to meet the treatment cost. Please help this child to have a bright future. The donations sent through Ch/D/D/NEFT Transfer & GOOGLE PAY (Canara Bank, Nungambakkam Branch, A/c No. 60182010063310, IFSC No: CNRB0016018) favouring **WOMEN’S WELFARE SYNDICATE** is exempted under 80G IT. Your mail id is requested.

All correspondence is done through **WWS**, Regd Public Charitable Trust, Flat No. GF 1, Cordel Apartments, Q.No.13, N.No. 29, Pyroffs Garden Lane, Chennai-600006. Ph: 044-42137401/ 31523781/ 7338978027. E-mail ID: womenswelfaresyndicate@gmail.com
Website: www.womenswelfaresyndicate.org

WWS

Opposition’s Parliament Annexe meet demand ‘unusual’, says ECI

Poll panel says protocol requires meetings with political delegations to be held at its premises; it says it offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to receive the memorandum, but the offer was rejected by the protesting Opposition MPs

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

As the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), led by Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, sat on a more than eight-hour ‘dharna’ on Tuesday, the Election Commission of India (ECI) said that the Opposition parties had demanded a meeting with the full Commission at a venue outside the ECI premises, which was “unusual” and therefore “could not be accepted”.

The ECI said it had offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to the proposed meeting venue to receive the memorandum of the MPs, which in itself would have been an “unprecedented” step. However, this offer was also declined by the protesting leaders.

In an official statement issued after Mr. Gandhi was detained from his protest site inside Akashvani Bhavan, the headquar-



Congress leaders K.C. Venugopal, Rahul Gandhi, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others at the protest march demanding Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation on Tuesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

ters of All India Radio in the national capital, the poll body said it had learnt through the media till 4 p.m. that some Members of Parliament wished to meet the Commission along with their delegation during a march by certain political parties towards the ECI.

“With regard to today’s developments, it is clarified that, till 4.00 p.m. to-

day, no political party, through its representatives, had sought an appointment for a meeting with the Election Commission,” it said.

However, at around 4.00 p.m., information was received from the Delhi Police that a delegation of MPs, led by Mr. Gandhi, wished to meet the Commission and submit a memorandum.

Following this, when the Election Commission was considering the request, it was informed by the DCP, Delhi Police, that the delegation comprised 240 MPs and that the proposed venue was the Parliament House Annexe. “The Election Commission considered this request as unusual and therefore, could not be accepted, as, in accordance with ECI

No political party had sought an appointment for a meeting with the ECI till 4 P.M., it said

protocol, such meetings are held only on the premises of the Election Commission of India,” the statement said.

The ECI said it instead offered to send its senior-most officer on duty to receive the memorandum, but the offer was rejected by the Opposition MPs.

The statement further said that in 2025, the ECI had laid down a procedure for meetings with political parties. All political parties had been informed of the same. Under the procedure, whenever a delegation of a political party or a joint delegation of several parties wishes to meet the Commission, it seeks an appointment through its duly authorised representative. The meeting is thereafter held at a time mutually agreed upon, it said.

Cong. avoiding hard work, is making ‘false’ vote-theft allegations, alleges BJP MP

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Tuesday accused the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and the Congress of targeting constitutional institutions out of frustration over repeated electoral defeats, while opposing positions they had previously taken on the verification of voters.

Criticising Mr. Gandhi and campaign efforts of the Congress, BJP MP and spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said, “The reality is that they avoid the hard work themselves and make allegations of ‘vote theft’. Those who are unwilling to work are now making the loudest noise about wrongdoing by others.”

“Mr. Gandhi should explain in how many Assembly elections he has personally campaigned for his party. Has he ever stayed continuously for 15 days, 10 days, or even one week [in a State]?,” he asked, pointing to Union Home Minister Amit Shah’s extended stay in West Ben-



Sudhanshu Trivedi

gal ahead of the election.

On the issue of electoral rolls, he said Congress leaders had themselves previously highlighted the need to identify duplicate, deceased, and shifted voters, but were now questioning the process. “The Congress should clarify whether it was correct in 2016, 2018, and 2020-21, or whether it is correct today. Both cannot be true at the same time,” he said.

Cites figures

Mr. Trivedi also mentioned figures related to voters that he said had been flagged as deceased, shifted, and duplicate or non-traceable. “Today, when Congress leaders are talk-

ing about 13 crore voters, 2.8 crore of them are deceased, 6.8 crore have shifted, 1 crore are duplicate voters, and 3 crore are absent or non-traceable...,” he said, questioning how deceased and duplicate voters could be counted.

He cited suspected beneficiaries identified through verification of ration cards and Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act records to stress the need for verification of voter lists. After the BJP government came to power, he said, 5.8 crore ration cards were found belonging to “non-existent” people. Similarly, he said that when MGNREGA cards were verified after 2019, 4.45 crore “non-existent” beneficiaries were found.

Accusing Mr. Gandhi of making false allegations against constitutional institutions, he said: “The ‘first family’ of the Congress has, for the last four generations, ‘held the throat of democracy’ and run a system of ‘monarchy under the guise of democracy’.”

Day-long defiance: Rahul captures the airwaves from Akashvani Bhavan

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

It looked as though the protests were winding down around noon on Tuesday, as buses packed with protesting MPs trundled away from Akashvani Bhavan in the national capital after nearly two hours of sloganeering.

Only Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi had another idea. “This can’t end here,” Mr. Gandhi told his colleagues. “Where is Priyanka [Gandhi]? Where is Akhilesh [Yadav]?” he asked. Both leaders had been packed into buses by the police.

Many Congress MPs, along with Ms. Gandhi, got down from the buses they had been packed into. But the bus carrying Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, which also had Trinamool Congress’s Abhishek Banerjee, CPI(M)’s John Brittas and others, had already left the site.

Mr. Gandhi first proposed that the remaining group march to India Gate and tried walking back towards Parliament, away



Strong pushback: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi trying to get out of a police van after being detained during a protest in New Delhi. AP

from the barricades, only to be told that all roads were blocked. So, he turned back.

In front of Akashvani Bhavan, he spotted All India Radio staffers who had spent two hours standing on the parapet wall and watching the protest unfold. He waved at them and then, without any warning, waded into the crowd and headed for the narrow pedestrian gate of the complex. He squeezed his way into the premises.

A few Congress MPs managed to follow. Others, including senior leaders K.C. Venugopal and Pawan Khera, were initially

stopped at the gate and stood at the grills before the Delhi Police, after some discussion, allowed them to join Mr. Gandhi.

Around 2.30 p.m., a large group of Indian Youth Congress (IYC) and National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) activists descended on Akashvani Bhavan. Catching the heavily deployed police personnel by surprise, the activists charged at the iron gates, with many managing to run into the campus. The police reacted swiftly, slamming the gates shut, this time with the activists inside. Buses soon arrived to detain them.

One young activist clambered onto the roof of a police bus and waved an NSUI flag. He was later pulled down by a Delhi Police officer. The buses eventually cleared the premises of the activists.

Meanwhile, Mr. Gandhi and a small group of Congress leaders continued their sit-in under a banyan tree. By evening, with Mr. Gandhi and the Congress leadership refusing to budge, more leaders joined in. Trinamool Congress leaders Derek O’Brien and Mahua Moitra, who had been bundled away by the police earlier, returned to the site.

Around 8 p.m., the Delhi Police finally moved to clear the campus. Officers first removed the leaders gathered around Mr. Gandhi one by one. Finally, Mr. Gandhi himself was dragged towards a minibus. He resisted throughout, at one point even attempting to wriggle out through a window.

In videos later shared by the Congress, leaders detained at the Kingsway Camp police station could be seen raising slogans.

Union Cabinet passes resolution, hails PM on 25 years of continuous leadership

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet on Tuesday passed a resolution congratulating Prime Minister Narendra Modi on completing 25 years of continuous leadership as head of government.

The resolution traced how Mr. Modi carried Guja-

rat’s initiatives to the national stage.

It listed initiatives aimed at empowering women, encouraging startups, expanding opportunities for youth, supporting farmers and vulnerable tribal communities, also noting that over 25 crore people had been lifted out of poverty. The resolution flagged

Mr. Modi’s push for reforms “despite political risks”, referring to the GST and other measures.

“The resolution highlights Mr. Modi’s ability to give India direction through global upheaval. During COVID, he united the country, backed domestic vaccine development and enabled rapid vaccina-

tion. During the West Asia crisis, timely decisions and energy security measures helped India withstand disruption,” said a government release.

It said 2016 surgical strikes, 2019 Balakot air strikes and 2025 Operation Sindoor illustrated the national security red lines established under Mr. Modi.

Left off poll rolls, 4 West Bengal men detained for a month in Chhattisgarh

Senjuti Sengupta
MURSHIDABAD

The Chhattisgarh Police have detained four migrant workers from Murshidabad, West Bengal over suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals, after their names were deleted from the voters’ list during the recent special intensive revision (SIR) exercise.

They have been lodged at a detention centre in Raipur for over a month despite reportedly being long-time Indian residents.

Late in August, at least 23 migrant workers, including the four persons Sabir Sheikh (42), Safikul Islam (39), Nasiruddin Sheikh (35), and Laltu Sheikh (28) from Samser-



Family members of the four migrant workers who have been lodged at the Chhattisgarh detention centre. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ganj and Sahabad areas of Murshidabad, went to Chhattisgarh in search of work. On September 4, the Chhattisgarh Police detained 23 persons from their residences in Chunchiapara-Ganesh Nagar on suspicion of being Bangladeshi nationals. They were taken to a holding centre in

Raipur for illegal immigrants.

Nineteen of them were released on September 18 after a local court passed an order while these four men continued to be lodged at the detention centre. The police, in court, questioned their nationality based on the dele-

tion of their names in the SIR exercise. Interestingly, the rest of the 19 persons found their names back on the voters list after the adjudication process.

“I have been staying in Samserganj since my childhood. Our old house was a century old, as my great-grandfather had probably built it. After it was washed away due to soil erosion, we set up our new residence in 1973. How could my son be a Bangladeshi?” said Safikul’s father, the 67-year-old Riyajul Sheikh.

They have appealed before the tribunal seeking restoration of their names.

The family members have also filed a petition in the Calcutta High Court seeking their release.

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The TGTransco invites online Bids under e-procurement for supply of the following Equipment's: 1. **Tender Specification No.TGPM11-38/26**, Description of Equipment: 33kV CTs (2000-1000-600/1-1-1)A. 2. **Tender Specification No. TGPM25-35/2026**, Description of Equipment: Supply of 50MVA 220/33kV Power Transformers.
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राज. स्वा. वि. वि. आयुर्विज्ञान महाविद्यालय में NICU/PICU/ICU के लिए कार्य की प्रकृति के आधार पर उच्च कुशल एवं अर्द्धकुशल मैनपावर (नर्स ग्रेड-II एवं वार्ड अटेंडण्ट्स) सेवाओं के उपायन हेतु दर सविदा हेतु (कुल अनुमानित लागत राशि रु. 2,00,00,00,0/-) दिनांक 22/10/2026 को अपरान्ह 02.00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। अधिक विवरण के लिए वेबसाइट Website sppp.rajinic.in or eprocrajasthan.gov.in का अवलोकन करें।
UBN:- CMS26275LOB00062
Raj Samwad/C/26/11337

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Bids for Annual Rate contract for Construction & commissioning of 200 mm dia tube wells with submersible pump sets etc. complete work in all types of strata & laying, jointing, testing, commissioning of HDPE pipe line including defect liability period of PANCHAYAT SAMITI AKLERA, MANOHARTHANA, JHALARAPATAN, KHANPUR, BAKANI, BHAWANI MANDI, DAG & PIRAEA of PHED Division Jhalawar/ Bhawani Mandi, District Jhalawar (With Material Complete) are invited from interested bidders upto 15.10.2025 at 18.00 Hours. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the www.dipr.rajabasthan.gov.in, <http://rajwater.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajabasthan.gov.in> and <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in>. Departmental websites.
NIB No. PHE2627A2840
UBN No. PHE2627WSRC06010, PHE2627WSRC06011, PHE2627WSRC06013
Superintending Engineer
PHED Circle Jhalawar
DIPRC/17083/2026

**Andhra Pradesh Drones Corporation Pvt. Ltd.**
(An Enterprise of the Government of Andhra Pradesh)
3rd Floor, NTR Administrative Block, Pandit Nehru Bus Station, NH-65, Vijayawada-520013, Andhra Pradesh.
Notice No: APDC/RFP/02/2026, Dt. 07-10-2026

Andhra Pradesh Drones Corporation Pvt Ltd (APDC) invites tenders through two-bid system from Potential Drone Manufacturers / OEMs for Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Training and Post-Supply Support of Geospatial Survey and Mapping Drone Systems in Andhra Pradesh. Interested firms are requested to submit their bid proposals. The RFP document & other details can be downloaded from the website (<https://apdrones.ap.gov.in/home/tenders>) & bids can be submitted through the e-Procurement Platform of the Government of Andhra Pradesh (<https://tender.apereprocurement.gov.in>).
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CIN:U24232RJ2011SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- F02 (459)/RMSCL/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-21/2026-27/5192 A **Dated :- 28/09/2026**
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e-Bids are invited by RMSCL, Jaipur from bonafide MANUFACTURERS / LOAN LICENSEE / IMPORTERS / CO- MARKETERS with sole marketing rights for imported proprietary items for rate contract cum supply and empanelment of bidders for Drugs & Medicines. The last date of submission of duly filled up form along with documents on e-proc i.e. <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in> and submission of fees is upto 06.00 PM of 27.10.2026 Details of NIB may be seen at the website of State Public Procurement Portal <https://sppp.rajabasthan.gov.in/>, <http://eproc.rajabasthan.gov.in>, <http://rmshc.health.rajasthan.gov.in> and may be downloaded from there.
Estimated Value (Rs.): - 132.17 Crore
UBN No. - MSC2627GLOB00061 **Director (Proc.)**
Raj Samwad/C/26/11364 **RMSCL, Jaipur**

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No.KPCL/2026-27/PS/WORK/ INDENT4878 **Date: 03.10.2026**
ABSTRACT BID NOTIFICATION
(Through KPP Portal only) (Two Cover System)
KPCL invites bids through GoK KPP Portal Platform <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from the qualified bidders for the following scope of work.
"Design, Engineering, Manufacture, quality surveillance, inspection & testing at manufacturer's works, supply, packing, forwarding, transportation to site, unloading storage, preservation, handling, insurance, dismantling of existing Platen Super Heater (PLSH), Re-heater (RH) & Final Super Heater (FSH) coil assemblies, erection, testing and commissioning of new PLSH, RH & FSH coil assemblies along with connected accessories, including hydraulic testing & steam blowing, for the 210 MW Unit-1 Boiler at Raichur Thermal Power Station of KPCL". Last Date and Time for submission Tender : 03.11.2026 at 17:00 hours.
Further details can be had form: **Chief Engineer (Thermal Designs)**, KPCL, No.3, 2nd Floor, Green Building, (Drug Controller Office Premises), Palace Road, Bengaluru-560 001. **Mobile: 9480682537, E-mail: kpclcetd@gmail.com, cetd kpcl@gmail.com, cetdeerm@gmail.com Website: <https://kpcl.karnataka.gov.in>**

INBRIEF



President Murmu urges doctors to embrace sensitivity

President Droupadi Murmu on Tuesday said that the primary objective of the medical profession should be to serve humanity, urging doctors to embrace sensitivity and compassion while striving for excellence. She was addressing the first convocation of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) at Bilaspur in Himachal Pradesh. Noting that medical professionals often hesitate to serve in inaccessible areas, she said the nation expects doctors graduating from prestigious institutions to rise above this mindset. Bringing healthcare facilities to people at the last rung of society should be the primary mission of their lives, the President told students.

HC seeks Salman's reply on Kala Hiran producer's plea

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday sought actor Salman Khan's response to a plea by the makers of *Kala Hiran: The Battle for Legacy* seeking to stay proceedings in the actor's suit against the film's proposed release. The court issued notice to Mr. Khan on the application, in which producer Amit Jani argued that the dispute over the film is already the subject of an earlier suit filed by the actor. Mr. Khan has sought to restrain the release of the film, which he claims is based on him. The producer, however, fresh proceedings amount to parallel litigation.

DRDO's flight trial of high-altitude platform successful

The Hindu Bureau

NEW DELHI

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) has successfully carried out the flight trial of an indigenously developed High-Altitude Platform (HAPS), with the experimental platform reaching an altitude of 21 km above mean sea level and remaining at 20 km for more than 30 minutes.

The Defence Ministry said the platform, developed by the Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment, Agra, was a lighter-than-air system being designed as a long-endurance stratospheric aerial surveillance platform. The platform carried several instrumentation and control electronic systems, including an inertial measurement unit, Global Positioning System receiver, onboard



The High Altitude Platform System. DRDO

cameras and an altitude-control mechanism, besides other subsystems.

'Key milestone'

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh congratulated the DRDO, the IAF, public sector undertakings and industry involved in the trial, describing the achievement as an important milestone in India's Aatmanirbhar Bharat drive.

More than half of overnight travel is by bus: NSO survey

India's first national travel survey finds 55.8% of overnight household journeys are by bus and 17.7% by rail; two-wheelers are main mode of transport for daily work, accounting for 42.6% of journeys

Jagriti Chandra

NEW DELHI

Buses are used significantly more than trains for overnight travel in India, with more than half of all household overnight journeys undertaken by bus, according to the country's first-ever National Household Travel Survey released by the National Statistics Office (NSO) on Monday.

The survey found that 55.8% of overnight household journeys are undertaken by bus, compared with 17.7% by inter-city railways. Together, buses and railways account for nearly three-fourths, or 73.5% of all overnight travel. Cars account for 15.1% of such journeys, while two-wheelers make up another 8.8%.

Railway use is significantly higher among urban households. About 22.7% of urban households use rail for overnight journeys, compared with around 14% of rural households.

Overnight journeys, however, are largely not undertaken for tourism. The survey found that 70.2% of



The survey found that 70.2% of overnight household trips are for social, communication, and religious purposes. FILE PHOTO

overnight household trips are for social, communication, and religious purposes. Culture, leisure, sports and tourism account for just 7.4% of such trips.

The daily commute

The pattern changes sharply when it comes to daily travel to work. Two-wheelers are the dominant mode of transport for workers, accounting for 42.6% of journeys. Their share rises to 52.3% among urban workers, compared with 37.1% in rural areas.

Public transport has a much smaller share of daily workforce mobility nationally. Buses account for

6.7% of work trips, while trains, the monorail, and trams together account for 2.1%. However, urban mass transit is considerably more important in some States and cities.

In Maharashtra, metro, suburban rail, monorail, and trams account for 20.7% of urban worker commutes, followed by West Bengal at 16.5% and Delhi at 14.4%, against the national urban average of 5%.

The survey also shows that most Indians have relatively short daily commutes.

The average journey to a fixed workplace takes 25

minutes, with the average rising to 27 minutes in urban areas.

The average monthly expenditure on commuting to a fixed workplace is ₹785 per worker.

Urban workers spend substantially more, at ₹1,044 a month, compared with ₹612 for rural workers. Male workers spend an average of ₹835 on their commute each month, against ₹533 for female workers.

The survey also highlights a gender disparity in workforce mobility. While 61.9% of male workers undertake work-related trips of more than one kilometre, the corresponding share for women is only 41.9%.

There is also a gender gap in commuting expenditure: male workers spend an average of ₹835 a month, compared with ₹533 for female workers.

The National Household Travel Survey, conducted between July 2025 and June 2026, covered 4,92,023 households and 20,34,371 people across 14,274 villages and 10,377 urban blocks.

There is no one-size-fits-all approach to climate action, India says at pre-COP31 talks

Jacob Koshy

NEW DELHI

Union Environment Minister Bhupendra Yadav has called for equal attention to adaptation, mitigation, and means of implementation as the world heads towards the United Nations Climate Change Conference, or COP31 Summit, in Antalya in Türkiye in November.

The principles of equity and Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC) must be upheld "in letter and spirit," Mr. Yadav said.

Addressing the Leaders' Plenary in Fiji, where he is leading India's delegation to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change's (UNFCCC) pre-COP31 meetings, Mr. Yadav said there could be no "one-



Bhupendra Yadav

size-fits-all" pathway to climate action.

Local studies and assessments, he said, were key to identifying emerging challenges, mitigation and adaptation measures, and the resources needed, a press statement from the Environment Ministry said.

The talks in Nadi, Fiji, and on the atoll nation of Tuvalu, co-hosted by Australia, Fiji and Tuvalu, are a precursor to the COP31 in Türkiye. Referring to In-

dia's long coastline and islands, Mr. Yadav said the country understood the challenges of Pacific Island countries. Institutions such as the Indian Space Research Organisation, the National Centre for Sustainable Coastal Management, and the National Centre for Coastal Research had built expertise in coastal vulnerability assessment, shoreline change mapping, marine spatial planning, and integrated coastal management.

Shared knowledge

India also uses space-based Earth observation for shoreline monitoring, inundation assessment, cyclones, extreme weather early warning, and climate risk assessment, Mr. Yadav said, and offered to share this knowledge with Pacific partner countries.

Railway Board tells officials to maintain cleanliness on trains

Maitri Porecha

NEW DELHI

Following repeated passenger complaints regarding poor upkeep, foul bio-toilets, and unhygienic coach conditions on long-distance routes, the Railway Board has stepped in with strict directives to overhaul cleanliness standards across the Indian Railways.

In a letter sent to all railway zones, the Railway Board directed focused, end-to-end monitoring measures for long-distance services, moving away from brief clean-ups at originating stations to sustained upkeep throughout the journey.

"As part of the first phase, 11 high-priority trains with journey times exceeding 40 hours have been identified for enhanced oversight," a Railways official said.

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit appointed next Indian Air Force chief

Saurabh Trivedi

NEW DELHI

Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit has been appointed the next Chief of the Air Staff, the Defence Ministry announced on Tuesday.

He is currently the Vice-Chief of the Air Staff and will take over the top post on October 31, succeeding Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh, who retires on the same day.

Air Marshal Dixit will be the 29th Chief of the Air Staff. A fighter pilot with nearly four decades of service, he has more than 3,500 hours of flying experience on a range of aircraft, including the Mirage-2000, MIG variants, Jaguar, IL-78, Hawk, and Tejas, the Ministry said.

Key operations

Commissioned into the fighter stream of the Indian Air Force on December 6, 1986, Air Marshal Dixit has held several key operational and staff appointments.

Before taking over as Vice-Chief of the Air Staff, he served as Chief of Integrated Defence Staff to the Chairman, Chiefs of Staff Committee (CISC) at Headquarters Integrated De-



Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

fence Staff and as Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Central Air Command. During his career, he has commanded a frontline fighter airbase in the Western Sector and a fighter training base in the Southern Sector.

He has also been involved in several operations and exercises, including Operation Safed Sagar, Operation Rakshak, and Operation Sindoor.

He is an alumnus of the National Defence Academy; Defence Staff Service College, Bangladesh; and National Defence College. He was awarded the Vayu Sena Medal in 2006, Vishisht Seva Medal in 2011, Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2023 and Param Vishisht Seva Medal in 2026 for his service.

Self-reliance begins with aero engines: Rajnath Singh

The Hindu Bureau

NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday called for building indigenous aero-engine capabilities as a critical component of India's ambition to develop the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA), stressing that self-reliance in aerospace cannot be achieved without mastering propulsion technology.

Speaking at Hindustan Aeronautics Limited's (HAL) Koraput division, Mr. Singh highlighted a proposed investment of around ₹5,000 crore for developing indigenous aero-engine capabilities for the AMCA.

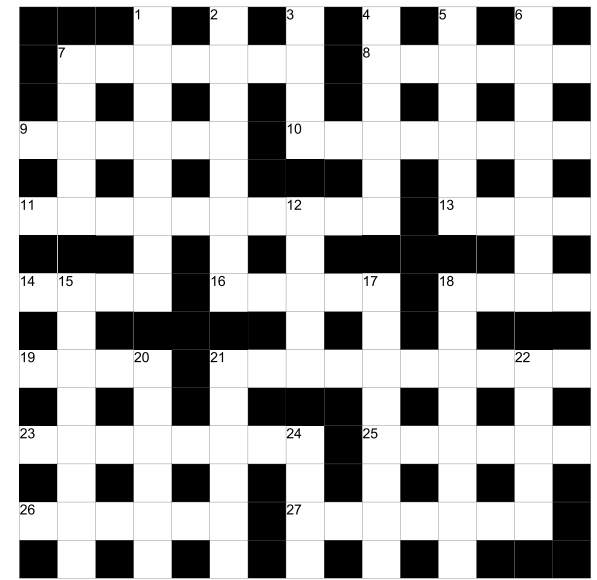
He also mentioned the planned indigenisation of raw materials in partnership with Mishra Dhatu Nigam Limited and establishment of India's first indigenous high-thrust engine testing facility.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14917

(set by Saral)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



14. Primate enshrines relics finally in church area (4)
16. Energy and pressure throwing off Mark's garden tool (5)
18. Right away chopping shrub and plant (4)
19. Quick huge returns investing lakhs initially (4)
21. Withdrawing from skipping around institute street (10)
23. Intense anxiety of soldier in Kohima leaving occasionally (8)
25. Deans ordering small cars (6)
26. Idle talk of girl with very large drink (6)
27. Son left terrible bar in retreat (7)
- DOWN
1. Translator unwilling to go through? (8)
2. Confused angry supermodels ignoring short role perhaps (6,2)
3. Swelling troubling your eye from the beginning? (4)
4. Bird's blurry image outside park (6)
5. Some craftsmen principally working next to church in defensive fort (6)
6. Stench spreading across again in gutters (8)
7. Cramps while cycling in country (5)
12. Throws dishes (5)
15. Look at daughter's pants, primarily spoiling dress design (5,3)
17. Piece of music in D sharp, old composing melody at last (8)
18. Support doctor with operation theatre setting (8)
20. Baker's chief to promote cook (6)
21. Disheartened director with an expression of apology, bows (6)
22. Group of players went on playing missing introduction (5)
24. Teacher hiding pain (4)

- ACROSS
7. Surplus force entering certain industrial town at first (7)
8. Agreement of a conservative on bond (6)
9. Partially scan vast painting (6)
10. Former writer, say penning new books for promoter (8)
11. One preparing rice blend. Fantastic! (10)
13. Copy part of the chorus (4)

SUDOKU

	1	8					6	
		5			6	4	1	
					9	3	5	
			6	7	5			
	4					7		
			2	9	4			
8	6	9						
4	9	3			6			
2					9	7		

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

Solution to previous puzzle	Solution to yesterday's Sudoku
NURSERIERYHYMES RULPAEITSC ONTRACKSHELTER MARGEELEAO APATHYBADADEBTS NEEREL NIGHTYICEPOINT UATTHERSH MARTINISTECHIE EILRCL RACEDUNO AALDUNO LOLLINGNOCANDO SDSUATNR DISTINGUISHED	956183724 418726953 723549186 145278639 869435217 237961548 382617495 574892361 691354872

FAITH

Practise, repeat, practise

Practice makes perfect is an oft repeated axiom in life. Perseverance is key, an aspect reiterated by Lord Krishna to Arjuna in the Bhagavad Gita. Tiruvalluvar says, "He who desires not the personal pleasure, but focuses entirely on completing his duty will stand as a pillar of strength and support to one's family and relatives (Kural 615)". One should never give up in life but persevere. Abhyasa— any repeated activity – in any field will yield results, and same is the true of spirituality, said Swami Sivayoganandha.

Having the desire to evolve devotionally is a good base upon which one can develop further. Spending 20 minutes focusing entirely on God, chanting a mantra whereby one controls the wandering mind is the starting point. Lord Krishna says, "If you are unable to fix your mind steadily upon Me, then by the yoga of constant practice seek to reach Me, Oh Dhyanajaya", (CH XII, V 9). Nowhere does Krishna say it is easy, aware as He is of human nature. In fact, He further states that if one is unable to even practise Abhyasa yoga, one should intently perform actions for Krishna's sake. One will soon achieve perfection by this method as well. Meditate and dedicate it to Him. Shed ego and do just what God bids you to do: which is to lead a dharmic life and do what is good for the world. One should be like the sun. Regardless of all things else, it always rises and performs its function afresh. The sun does not expect anything in return. Similarly work is its own reward. One should not try to extricate oneself from a task merely because it is difficult; the art of executing it comes from repeated exertion. Only when his mind is light can a person find true happiness.

NEW DELHI
Twelve crew members injured
after tanker attacked off Oman



REUTERS

Twelve crew members on a Panama-flagged tanker were injured in an attack while crossing the Strait of Hormuz on Tuesday, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs said in a statement, with those injured receiving medical treatment in Oman. The Ministry said the tanker, *MT On Peace*, had a 19-member crew, including 17 Indians. AFP

BERLIN
Germany arrests ex-spy chief for
‘passing secrets to foreign powers’



AP

A former German spy chief was arrested on Tuesday on suspicion of passing sensitive information to foreign powers. August Hanning, who ran Germany's BND foreign intelligence agency from 1998 to 2005, is accused of espionage, treason and working for foreign intelligence services, federal prosecutors said. AFP

WASHINGTON
Trump approves firing squad
execution for Fort Hood shooter



AP

U.S. President Donald Trump has approved the execution by firing squad of Army Major Nidal Malik Hasan for the 2009 shooting rampage at Fort Hood, Texas. Thirteen people were killed and more than 30 injured when Hasan, an Army psychiatrist, walked into a medical building and opened fire with a laser-sighted handgun. AP

NAIROBI
Kenya confirms first Ebola case
after traveller from Congo dies



REUTERS

Kenyan authorities on Tuesday confirmed the country's first imported Ebola case from Congo, making Kenya the latest country affected by the fast-moving outbreak. Health Minister Aden Duale said a Kenyan citizen who arrived from Congo via Uganda tested positive for the Ebola virus and died late Monday. AP

Ukraine fires
900 drones
overnight
at Russia

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian air defences intercepted nearly 900 Ukrainian drones overnight over multiple regions of the country, as well as the occupied Crimean Peninsula and the Sea of Azov, the Defence Ministry in Moscow said on Tuesday. Unconfirmed media reports said a major fuel depot in the Moscow region was on fire after the attack that killed two people. Ukrainian officials are now bracing for what President Volodymyr Zelenskyy warned is an upcoming “massive” aerial attack by Russia. “Today, we received updated intelligence on Russia's preparations for a massive strike. We are preparing countermeasures,” Mr. Zelenskyy said. Meanwhile, the Russian Defence Ministry said its forces overnight struck targets in Ukraine's southern Odesa region on the Black Sea coast with drones, where an ammunition depot was hit.

Houthis ‘hit’ Riyadh airport;
Yemen military claims gains

The group denies being pushed back and says it still controlled territory seized during its recent advance along Yemen's Red Sea coast; Riyadh airport is facing temporary closures of its airspace

Agence France-Presse
SANAA

Yemen's Houthis (Ansar Allah) claimed an attack on the Saudi capital's main airport and on Tuesday denied being pushed back by government forces, who have launched a major operation to recapture lost territory. The Houthi statements come as Yemen's military said it had removed the pro-Iran group from areas around the Bab el-Mandeb strait, a Red Sea chokepoint, and the port city of Mokha. Claims by both sides in Yemen have been impossible to independently verify, with the situation on the ground moving fast and access for journalists difficult. Houthi military spokesperson Yahya Saree said the group still held all territory seized last month when they swept through



Pro-government fighters celebrate while riding vehicles in a convoy near the Bab el-Mandeb Strait in Taiz on Tuesday. AFP

coastal areas along the Red Sea oil-and-cargo route. Houthi fighters “have full control over all their advances on the ground”, he posted on Telegram. Mr. Saree said they had carried out dozens of strikes in the past few hours targeting government forces in Yemen's Al-Jawf and Marib regions, while also attacking Taiz governorate. On Monday, the Houthis said they had struck Ri-

yadh airport and a refinery belonging to Saudi state oil giant Aramco. Loud explosions rattled the Saudi capital on Monday evening. They were followed by another explosion on Tuesday that echoed through northern parts of the city, residents said. Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport is facing frequent temporary closures of its airspace, according to tracking website Flightradar24. Saudi authorities have not publicly acknowledged the closures or confirmed any strikes targeting the facility. But on Tuesday the civil aviation authority said at least three people were wounded in attacks on Jazan and Najran airports near the Yemen border a day earlier. Saudi Arabia, the main backer of the Yemeni government, has been providing air support for the counter-offensive launched by government forces. Government forces claimed late Monday that they had achieved “victories on several fronts”. But military sources with the government refrained from confirming Mokha's recapture, only saying they had cut the one supply route to the area. They also said they expelled the Houthis from several areas in Taiz in the southwest.

Jeffrey Archer, bestselling
British novelist, dies at 86

Associated Press
LONDON

Bestselling British author Jeffrey Archer, whose career as a politician was derailed by a perjury conviction, has died. He was 86. Archer died “suddenly and peacefully” at his home on Monday, a day before the global release of his final novel, *Adam and Eve*, publisher HarperCollins said. Like his bestseller *Kane and Abel*, the new book follows a pair of biblically named characters born on the same day to different social classes. Both a celebrated author and scandal-plagued politician, Archer's professional life teetered between triumph and turmoil as he wrote his way through a brief prison sentence and returned to the political arena. His writing career spanned five decades and helped him bounce back from financial ruin following some bad investments. His debut novel, *Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less*, hit the shelves in 1976 and was said to have been in-



Jeffrey Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher. NAGARA GOPAL

spired by his own experience nearly going bankrupt. He went on to spend 14 years and five months on Britain's *Sunday Times* bestseller lists and over five years on *The New York Times* bestseller lists, selling 300 million books worldwide, according to HarperCollins. **Political stint** Archer climbed the ranks of Britain's Conservative Party under Prime Minister Margaret Thatcher and was appointed in 1992 to the House of Lords by her successor, Prime Minister John Major. Archer was cast out of his political party just before he was jailed on perjury charges in 2001. Archer chronicled his time behind bars in a three-volume series titled *A Prison Diary*. The memoirs – *Hell, Purgatory and Heaven* – shared rare insight into the lives of inmates in British prisons, from the high-security HMP Belmarsh to the North Sea Camp open prison. Archer is survived by his wife of 60 years, Dame Mary Archer, their two sons, two granddaughters and three grandsons, his publisher said.

Why NASA wants to build a
nuclear reactor on the moon

NEWS ANALYSIS

Vasudevan Mukunth



View of Moon limb. ISTOCKPHOTO

NASA wants to install a nuclear reactor near the moon's south pole by 2030. Its planned output, 20 kilowatt (kW), could power a few households on earth. Russia's planned reactor for the International Lunar Research Station (ILRS), led by China, will produce around 10 kW. But the fact that they are nuclear makes them significant. The U.S. and China are pursuing parallel efforts today – in partnership with other countries – to be the first to set up a semi-permanent, and in future permanent, moon base. Such a facility will need electricity for everything from heating and life-support to recharging rover batteries. European scientists are also exploring lunar microreactors. At most locations on the moon, a fortnight of daylight follows a fortnight of darkness. Near the south pole, where both factions are focusing their activities, promontories and craters create a pastiche of lit and shadowed patches, with temperatures inside some of the latter dipping under a frigid -200 C. But unlike solar panels, a nuclear reactor can produce power even in the dark. The colder craters preserve water ice, which can quench astronauts' thirst and can also be electro-

lysed to produce hydrogen and oxygen, to power rockets launched from the moon itself. In one 2020 assessment, NASA scientists Julie Kleinhenz and Aaron Paz figured producing 10 tonnes of oxygen this way would require around 68 kW of power. So a 20-kW reactor could be a stepping stone in countries' plans to set up an array of reactors on the moon. While the moon as a whole is barren, the more ideal locations, with longer periods of sunlight, terrain more suitable to land on, access to craters with water ice, and so on, are highly limited. Research commissioned by NASA has recommended situating nuclear reactors at least 1 km away from humans. Now, the Outer Space Treaty 1967 says no country may appropriate any part of the moon through occupation or other means. But the Artemis Accords, to which the U.S. and its allies vis-à-vis the moon are signatories, envisage 'safety zones' to prevent harmful interference. Put differently, a state does not have to stake territory

on the moon to limit access to others: it can simply plonk a nuclear reactor there and appeal to the need for legitimate safety requirements. The Accords say these zones must be temporary and respect free access – but a country or a bloc operating a cluster of reactors, landing pads, mines, and habitats could nevertheless gain a controlling advantage. For the appeal of this idea, however, both Artemis and ILRS face breathtaking technical hurdles. Shielding a nuclear reactor on the moon demands either launching the components to ensure its safe operation or producing them on the moon with lunar resources. Distanting a reactor from a base demands deployment machines and power cables. The reactor core will also have to be launched unirradiated and, once online, space agencies will have to find ways to absorb and store all the heat – or radiate waste heat away from large surfaces kept free of moon dust. If a reactor fails on the moon, it could contaminate the same few places astronauts would like to be at. While nuclear power could prove indispensable to a mature economy centred on the moon, no country possesses that economy today even as governments are being tempted to install reactors before their opponents – a danger in itself.

Rajasthan Medical Services Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking)
Gandhi Block, Swasthya Bhawan, Tilak Marg, Jaipur-302005, India
Phone No: 0141-2228066, 2228064 Website: www.rmssc.health.rajasthan.gov.in
CIN:U24232RJ2015SGC035067, E-mail: edprmsc@rajasthan.gov.in

Ref. No. :- E-02 (454)/RMSC/PROCUREMENT/DRUG/NIB-16/2026-27/5191 Dated :- 28/09/2026

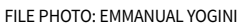
NOTICE INVITING E-Bids
e-Bids are invited by RMSC, Jaipur from bonafide MANUFACTURERS / LOAN LICENSEE / IMPORTERS / CO-MARKETERS with sole marketing rights for imported proprietary items for rate contract cum supply and empanelment of bidders for Drugs & Medicines. The last date of submission of duly filled up form along with documents on e-proc i.e. <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and submission of fees is upto 06.00 PM of 27.10.2026 Details of NIB may be seen at the website of State Public Procurement Portal. <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/>, <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in.>, <http://rmssc.health.rajasthan.gov.in> and may be downloaded from there.
Estimated Value (Rs.): - 278.77 Crore
UBN No. MSC2627GLOB00055
Raj.Samwad/CJ/26/11359
Director (Proc.)
RMSC, Jaipur

KARNATAKA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(CIN:U40109KA1999SGC025521)
No.CEE/T&P/SEE-1/2026-27/7165-80 Date: 05.10.2026

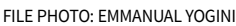
BRIEF TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal only)
KPTCL Invites Bids on electronic mode for the following works against following enquiry numbers on **Total Turnkey Basis**.
Sl.No. Enquiry number and Name of the Works
1. KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4259
Running of **220kV, 1200 sqmm UG Cable** as an alternate source for **220/66/11kV Koramangala GIS sub-station from 220/66/11kV HSR Layout sub-station** for a route length of **6.87km** along with construction of **220kV terminal bays** at both ends in Bengaluru South Taluk, Bengaluru Urban District.
2. KPTCL/2026-27/UC/WORK_INDENT4258(Short-term tender)
Running of **66kV, 630 sqmm UG Cable** from location No.43 to 54 in Cheelandavadi village state forest Cauvery wildlife protected area for a **distance of 1.265 kms**, as a part of the work of Construction of proposed 66kV SC Line on DC towers from existing 66/11 kV Doddalahalli S/S to proposed 66/11kV **Hegganur** sub-station in Kanakapura Taluk, Bengaluru South District.
The bids will be received through electronic tendering mode only. The details regarding participation in the e-tendering process can be obtained by logging on to KPTCL website <https://kptcl.karnataka.gov.in> with hyperlink "E Procurement KPTCL" or <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> on or after **09.10.2026 at 15:00 hrs.** Last date & time for receipt of Bids and any extension of Due date for Bid submission will be intimated in the KPP Portal. Any other details required in this regard can also be had from the Office of the undersigned during Office hours.
All Corrigendum/Addendums shall be noticed by the bidders before the last date of submission of the Bids.
Sd/- Chief Engineer(Electy.),
Tendering & Procurement, KPTCL, 9th Floor,
Indhana Bhavan, A.R Circle, Bengaluru-560009.

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିମିଟେଡ୍ (ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ) Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Jajpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007		
NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER		
E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
EIC- BharatNet -e- Tender- 3/2026-27	Supply and erection of 120 Nos 8/9 metre PSC Poles and stringing of OverHead ADSS Fibre (65Km) in Bharatnet phase-II network in Odisha. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 20.10.2026 upto 12:30 PM.	Rs. 45,67,190/-
CPC- 68/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection and commissioning of Strengthening of Existing Overhead Lines within 60kms of Coastal belt Districts in priority towards mitigation projects for construction of Disaster Resilient Power Infrastructure from SDMF on Turnkey Contract basis in e-tendering mode only. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 04.11.2026 upto 11:00 Hrs.	Rs. 1,15,64,95,241/-
CPC- 71/2026-27	Design, Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and commissioning of (I) 765/400/220kV GIS Sub-Station at Khuntuni (At Betakholi) with 3x1500MVA, 765/400kV ICT, 2x240MVAR, 765kV Bus reactor, 3 x 500MVA, 400/220kV ICT and 1x125MVAR, 400kV Bus reactor (ii) 765 kV DC LINE HEXA ACSR ZEBRA from existing 765/400 kV AIS Grid S/S, PGCIL, Phulapada (Angul) - To proposed 765/400/220kV GIS S/S, Betakholi (74.059 kms) (iii) 400 kV Quad MOOSE LINE from Betakholi to Mendhasal on Multi Circuit Towers (31.92 kms) and one no. dia extension at 400/220/132 kV Grid S/S, Mendhasal for connectivity of 400kV Betakholi-Mendhasal Transmission Line on EPC Contract basis in e- tendering mode only. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 16.11.2026 upto 12:45 PM.	Rs. 16,76,95,79,953/-
CPC- 76/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Procurement of Structure Materials & HDG Nut & bolts for Balance work of two nos. 132kV feeder bay extension each at 220/132/33kV Grid Sub-Station, Jaypatna and 132/33 kV Grid Sub-Station Junagarh and 132kV DC line from existing 220/132/33kV Grid Substation, Jaipatna (Baner) to LILO point (Loc no. 41/1).	Rs. 5,50,22,814/-
CPC- 77/2026-27	Bids invited from reputed bidders for Carrying out Forest clearance work of an area of approx. 90Ha of land proposed for construction of 400kV Quad Moose DC Line from Jeypore GSS(PGCIL) to Theruvali GSS.	Rs. 1,35,48,005/-
Complete set of bidding documents are available at www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL and www.optcl.co.in .		
© f @ /optcl.odisha ② /optcl_odisha		HIPR-64/2026-27

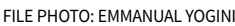
You gave Indian cricket everything as captain, Harman: Yuvraj



‘Since the day I made my debut,
you’ve always been there for me’



BCCI invites applications for Agarkar's replacement



ICC PoTM award: Abhishek, Gill, Shafali, Shree Charani nominees



Tap in: Sanabria, foreground, slots home Uruguay's fifth goal. K.R. DEEPAK

India's fight fades as Uruguay nets six

Harmanpreet quits captaincy, Smriti named new skipper

Harmanpreet gets the timing right in leaving leadership role

The dates: Oct. 23, 25 and 28.
All matches at Vadodara. Start time 2 p.m.

INBRIEF



Djokovic triumphs as de Minaur retires injured

Novak Djokovic won his seventh China Open title after Alex de Minaur retired with a groin injury during the final in Beijing on Tuesday. de Minaur left the court for a medical timeout after losing the first-set tie-breaker, but played on with his left thigh bandaged. However, he had to stop after winning the first game of the second set, leaving him trailing 6-7(3), 1-0. Sixth-ranked Djokovic's win continued his unbeaten record at the tournament with 34 straight victories.

IOC confirms India's interest in hosting the 2036 Olympics

India, Qatar and South Africa were confirmed on Tuesday among the seven countries interested in hosting the 2036 Summer Olympics. Germany, Hungary, Turkiye and South Korea make up the rest of the current list issued by the International Olympic Committee (IOC). Other countries have until October 31 to declare an interest. In March 2027, the IOC Executive Board will draw up a shortlist of the interested parties, who will then enter dialogue with the Olympic body. India is most likely to host it in Ahmedabad, the venue for the 2030 Commonwealth Games.

McSweeney, Sutherland and Beardman do the star turn as Australia-A goes one up

AUS-A IN INDIA

Anish Pathiyil
PUDUCHERRY

Four wickets against his name, three with balls over 142 kmph on the speed gun. Mahli Beardman's ragging balls of fire proved too hot for India-A as it succumbed to a 125-run loss to Australia-A in the first one-dayer at the CAP Ground here on Tuesday.

The 21-year-old's timely strikes helped bowl the home side out for 149 after

Nathan McSweeney scored a fighting hundred (123, 135b, 13x4) to post a target of 275. Rajat Patidar was the only Indian batter (53, 51b, 5x4, 1x6) to put up some resistance.

After choosing to bat, Australia-A was pushed on to the back foot quickly. Yash Thakur used the short ball to force Mitch Owen and Sam Konstas into mistimed pulls.

With two more edges finding the fielders, the visitor found themselves in trouble at 87 for five. But McSweeney and captain

Will Sutherland (77, 68b, 2x4, 4x6) arrested the slide with a sixth-wicket partnership of 141.

Upping the ante

Sutherland shifted gears as the lights came on for the final hour of the innings. He used his long levers to loft spinners into the leg-side fence. Just as Australia-A's fightback looked set to help it reach 300, Suryansh Shedge (four for 40) picked three in four overs to close out the innings.

Despite Beardman sending the Indian top-order

packing by beating them with his pace, India-A continued to harbour hopes of chasing the total down with its extended batting line-up.

Patidar managed to forge steady partnerships with skipper Rituraj Gaikwad (15) and Nishant Sindhu (31). But once they fell, the lower-order folded up.

The scores: Australia-A 274 in 48.2 overs (Nathan McSweeney 123, Will Sutherland 77, Thakur 3/47, Shedge 4/40) bt India-A 149 in 31.4 overs (Rajat Patidar 53, Beardman 4/23). **Toss:** Australia-A; **PoM:** McSweeney.



In full flow: McSweeney's ton took Australia-A to 274. X@CAP

France roars back to rout Belgium; Italy beats Turkiye



Influential: Olise's scruffed shot trickles past the Belgian defence for France's third. AFP

NATIONS LEAGUE

Agence France-Presse
PARIS

Michael Olise starred as France stormed back from behind to thrash Belgium 4-1 in the UEFA Nations League on Monday, while Italy continued its resurgence with victory over Turkiye.

Dodi Lukebakio's first-half strike had Belgium on track for a first competitive victory over France since 1981, but Zinedine Zidane turned to his star-studded bench and the host produced a devastating late surge.

Les Bleus struck four times in the final 13 minutes to keep Zidane's unbeaten record as coach intact as France edged closer to a place in the quarterfinals.

Desire Doue equalised with a low shot from the edge of the box before Olise pulled the ball back for Rayan Cherki to put France ahead. Olise put the game to bed with a scruffy third goal before

he grabbed another in stoppage time to round off a breathtaking turnaround.

France holds a three-point lead over Italy in Group A1, with Belgium another point behind.

Italy, rebuilding under Roberto Mancini, moved up into second place courtesy of a 3-1 win over Turkiye in Bologna.

Gianluca Scamacca drilled Italy ahead only for Aral Simsir to level just after the hour. The Azzurri, who thrashed Turkiye 4-1 last week in Bursa, secured another win at home with goals from Riccardo Calafiori and Pio Esposito.

The results: League A: Group 1: France 4 (Doue 77, Cherki 81, Olise 88, 90+1) bt Belgium 1 (Lukebakio 35); Italy 3 (Scamacca 26, Calafiori 64, Esposito 87) bt Turkiye 1 (Simsir 61). **League B: Group 2:** Ukraine 1 (Varechchuk 83) lost to Hungary 2 (Toth 52, Csinger 85); Northern Ireland 0 drew with Georgia 0. **Group 4:** Romania 0 lost to Sweden 1 (Gyokeres 13); Bosnia 1 (Basic 84-pen) bt Poland 0. **League C: Group 2:** Cyprus 2 (Costi 70, Edwards 90+4) bt Latvia 1 (Daskevics 57); Montenegro 0 drew with Armenia 0.

Indians get pride of place for WTT Feeder

TABLE TENNIS

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

India will be seeded at the top in four of the five categories in the World Table Tennis Feeder tournament to be held at the Tamil Nadu Physical Education and Sports University (TNPE-SU) near here from October 28 to November 1.

India's Manav Thakkar (World ranked 48) and Sachi Aoki (WR 55) of Japan have been given the top billing in men's and women's singles.

In men's and women's doubles, Ankur Bhattacharjee and Akash Pal and Diya Chitale-Yasashwini Ghorpade pair have been seeded No.1 while Harmeet Desai and Yashaswini Ghorpade have been given the pride of place in the mixed doubles.

Other prominent Indians in men's singles are Ankur, G. Sathiyam, Harmeet and S.F.R. Snehit and Diya, Yashaswini, Divyanshi Bhowmick, Surtirtha Mukherjee and Nithya Mani in women's singles.

TNPESU will also host the WTT Youth Contender from October 23 to 26.

India's Manav Thakkar and Sachi Aoki of Japan have been given the top billing in men's and women's singles

Prabodh knocks out Balsekar



Aggression pays off: Prabodh rallied to stun second seed Balsekar. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

TENNIS

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Suraj Prabodh rallied to stun second seed Aditya Balsekar 3-6, 6-2, 7-6 (7-4) at the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship at the DLTA Complex here on Tuesday.

After losing the opening set, Prabodh adopted a more aggressive approach, a strategy that eventually paid dividends.

Fifth seed Oges Jaya was also knocked out in the first round, losing 7-5, 2-6, 6-4 to big-serving Raghav Jaisinghani. Fourth seed Udit Kamboj, however, avoided an upset with a 6-1, 7-5 win over rising youngster Aditya Mor.

In women's singles, fifth seed Aditi Rawat, seventh

seed Laxmi Siri Dandu, and eighth seed Sohini Mohanty registered wins.

Important results (round-of-32):

Men: Suraj Prabodh bt Aditya Balsekar 2-6, 6-2, 7-6(4); Udit Kamboj bt Aditya Mor 6-1, 7-5; Deep Munim bt Prajwal Tewari 6-7(3), 6-4, 6-4; Ajay Malik bt Dhiraj Vennapusa 7-6(8), 6-7(3), 6-1.

Women: Aditi Rawat bt L. Arunkumar 6-3, 7-5; Laxmi Siri Dandu bt A. Khorakiwala 6-2, 6-1; Sohini Mohanty bt Joell Nichole 7-5, 6-3; Bela Tamhankar bt Jasmine Rawat 6-4, 6-2.

Under-18: Boys: Praneel Sharma bt Sarthak Gaikwad 6-0, 6-3; Srivaant Mummadi bt Harsh Malik 6-0, 6-2; Om Ramesh Patel bt Mehul Jothish 6-2, 6-3; Aditya Mor bt Rishi Yadav 6-4, 6-3.

Girls: Savitha Bhuvaneshwar bt Sarena Gahlot 6-1, 6-1. Shreeniti Chowdhury bt Paavani Bisht 6-1, 6-0; Harsha Oruganti bt Vaishnavi Singh 6-2, 6-0; Iha Joshi bt Sree Velmanikandan 6-7(4), 6-3, 6-3.



Aditya Mehta hopes to deliver a special gift for his little one

CWEALTH CUE SPORTS

Tarun Shastry
CHENNAI

Aditya Mehta will have a little extra motivation when he takes the snooker table at the Commonwealth cue sports championships in Ahmedabad from Wednesday.

The former World No. 49 became a father in January, and there is one gift he would dearly love to take back home – an international title.

"I still haven't won an international tournament since my daughter's birth. That's a huge motivation. I'd like win a title for her," Aditya told *The Hindu*.

At 39, Aditya feels he has rediscovered a part of his game that had gone missing over the last few years due to injuries.

"There was a bit of a lull for me in the middle. I wasn't quite the player I used to be. I fell, and then I didn't really know where I was going. I've passed that phase now. I'm very comfortable with where I am today."

His approach to practice has changed, too.

"It is more about getting



Aditya.

quality out of those two or three hours," he said. "I try to go in every day and do something a little better."

Return to pro circuit

That renewed confidence has got Aditya thinking about a return to the professional circuit.

"A few years ago, I was not really sure whether I would ever want to go back to the professional tour. But if I continue down the road I've been on for the last year or so, I would like to have another crack at the pro tour."

For now, though, his sights are firmly set on Ahmedabad – and that special gift for his little one.

"I definitely feel the game is there, and I'd love to win this time".



File No. HO/Civil/T&E-E-5296/01/2025 28123, Dt.23/09/2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL)-III

IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/32/26-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Swimming Pool in the district of Kandhamal, Odisha.

2. Value of the Work : Rs.1705.25 Lakhs (Approx.)

3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months

4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt. 07.10.2026
ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt. 28.10.2026
iii. Opening date : 11.30 Hours of dt. 29.10.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/349/2627



OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, PHULBANI (R&B) CIRCLE, PHULBANI

E-mail : sernbpbulbani@gmail.com

Letter No. 2063 Dated : 01/10/2026

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) - Bid Identification No.CCE_R and B_PLB_05 of 2026_27

1. The Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** for construction of the **Building works** as detailed in the table below from eligible contractors.

2. Nature of work	: Building Works
3. No. of tenders	: Two Nos
4. Tender Cost	: Rs.10,000/- (through online) only.
5. Class of Contractor	: B and A Class
6. Date & Time of sale & receipt of Bids	: 10.00 AM of 07.10.2026 to 5.00 PM of 21.10.2026
7. Date of Opening of Bid	: 11.00 AM of 22.10.2026
8. The Bidders shall have to participate in online bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website https://tendersodisha.gov.in . Any addendum/Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason.	

Chief Construction Engineer, Phulbani (R&B) Circle, Phulbani.
34001/949/2627



Government Of Odisha - "e" Procurement of Notice

Bid Identification No. 12 of 2026-27

Notice No.3694 Dated.05.10.2026

Ref- TCN No.3691 Dated.05.10.2026

Sr.No.	Item	Details
1	The GENERAL MANAGER, OSAM BOARD invites percentage rate bids in Double cover system in ONLINE MODE only for work as detailed below :	
2	Nature of the work	Construction of Boundary wall at Nimapada Model Haat Nimapada
3	No of work	01 Nos
4	Bid Cost	Rs. 4000.00 online transfer.
5	Value of Tender	Rs. 1088727
6	Class of Contractor	D & C
7	Availability of BID Documents in the website	Dt. 07.10.2026 to 16.10.2026
8	Last date / time of Receipt of bids in the portal	Dt. 16.10.2026 up to 5.00 PM
9	Date of opening of bid	Dt. 21.10.2026 at 11.30 AM
10	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : https://tendersorissa.gov.in . Any Addendum/Corrigendum/Cancellation of the Tender etc. can also be seen in the website: https://tendersorissa.gov.in .	

Sd/- General Manager, O.S.A.M. Board, Bhubaneswar
39001/61/2627

From flying under the radar to flying high – the Savitha Shri story

The Chennai GM took the chess world by storm in her maiden Olympiad appearance, winning individual gold on the reserve board and helping India bag the team bronze

C. Shyam Sundar

Savitha Shri. Remember the name. She was the surprise package India unleashed at the 24th Olympiad in Uzbekistan recently. In a display which shocked the chess world and even herself, the 19-year-old laid down a marker for the future, with her progress set to be followed keenly. From being a kid who once sat across the table against Magnus Carlsen – who would soon go on to become the World champion in 2013 – to dazzling at the game’s ultimate team event, Savitha has come a long way. She won titles at the National level and on the world stage, bagging the under-12 crown in the World Cadets championship in 2018 and bronze in the World Rapid championship four years later.

Biggest achievements

She appeared to fly under the radar despite her talent and achievements. The Olympiad medals – individual and team – are probably her biggest prizes till date.

The Chennai WGM, who took the competition by storm with a gold medal on the reserve board, had picked up the game at the age of four watching her brother play.

However, it wasn’t a smooth ride initially. Her father Krishnan Baskar, who was working as an electrical technician in Singapore, initially thought chess wasn’t an expensive pursuit. He subsequently gave up his job abroad in an effort to back his daughter. “I got a chessboard for ₹500 and thought it was all that I needed to spend,” he said.

To his surprise, the expenses were more than what he could afford. When a little Savitha took to the game like a duck to water, the family couldn’t make ends meet and support the two children at the same time. Baskar said he had to ask his son, Mughesh, to give up chess and focus on academics. He has now completed his degree and begun working.

In the meantime, Savitha’s talent meant her father dived headlong into supporting her. He used to accompany her to tournaments and was delighted to watch her perform well.

At one point, the family began to feel the pinch financially. They had to pledge gold jewellery to make sure that her fledgling career didn’t hit a roadblock as funding her trips to play tournaments appeared to be beyond the means. “Savitha has become a mature person now,” Baskar said even as he waited patiently at the airport to welcome her after her exploits in Samarkand, where the Indian women’s team finished with a bronze.

He was delighted to see Savitha shine at the highest level and wished for more support. “*Unmaiya sollanum na, neraya support thevai* (honestly speaking, more is needed),” Baskar said, emphasising on the need for more funding to pursue chess at the top.

First-time experience

As confident as Baskar is about Savitha’s career, the teenager appears to be adapting to the new-found stardom. She didn’t seem to be weighed down by pressure despite appearing in her maiden Olympiad. “I didn’t feel it. I was part of a very supportive team... my teammates were awesome. They just told me to play my game,” she said about her undefeated run of eight victories and two draws at the global event.

She described her performance as “amazing”. “I wasn’t really expecting it. When I had four (wins) from four games, I thought I should keep pushing. As long as I score, it is better



for the team,” Savitha said while assessing her display, which was instrumental in the team clinching a spot on the podium.

She won on demand and also showed that she could defend resolutely when needed. The hard-fought draws in two matches saved the team from suffering defeats and kept it in the hunt for a medal. She, however, said: “I regret not being able to win in the final round.”

Unstoppable run

Savitha was flying in the first four rounds. But, in a surprise move, she was rested for the match against Poland, which the team went on to lose.

Asked about the decision that cost India dear, she said rather matter-of-factly: “Vantika [Agrawal] had won all three matches and was also in good form. Poland is not really that strong compared to the other teams we played. It’s unfortunate that we lost. Again, I don’t think I have to blame anyone. It was the captain’s (Swayams Mishra) decision. I completely agree with it.”

All praise for her teammates – Koneru Humpy, R. Vaishali, Diviya Deshmukh and Vantika – the Chennai player said: “What can I say? Such a supporting team. For me, it’s my first time in the Olympiad. All of them are such senior players... Humpy, Vaishali akka. They kept motivating me to play all the rounds.” But the amiable and confident



FLICKR & B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Savitha admitted that she was a bit nervous ahead of the contest against China.

“I did feel it at the start of the round. But once the game started, I wasn’t thinking about that,” she said, adding that playing five-six hours every game very tiring.

Pleasant surprise

Grandmaster Mishra couldn’t conceal his delight at the newcomer’s stunning streak. He felt that the early run gave her a lot of confidence and that she built on the fantastic start. “We expected her to do well but this one was a pleasant surprise, not just for me but for herself as well. She kept on winning, especially in many clutch games where we needed her to.”

Mishra was impressed with Savitha’s ability to recover from tough positions and win. “I think we need more players like her who are always fighting for the team.”

About her special qualities, the coach said: “Her confidence is very high... When going into the fourth hour, players get tired. That is where I think she was able to be very precise and accurate in most of her games. The moment others get tired, she has the highest energy.”

High praise from the team captain indeed!

Where it started

Savitha was trained initially by the late K. Thirukkalthay, a noted coach and former State chess association office-bearer.

“He taught me how to move the pieces. It all started from there. He was a very good coach,” she said, terming him as

“special” and the one who showed the way. She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts R. Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards.

What’s unique about her

Ramesh had good words to say about Savitha. “Over the board, she does the most practical things without much hesitation when most players would hesitate.” On her part, she said, “Ramesh sir helps by analysing games and offers psychological support. We work a lot on the middle and end-game”.

Representing India at the Olympiad was a dream for Savitha, according to her father. She made the opportunity count when it came along as she got a look-in after the experienced D. Harika opted out.

Baskar and his family were there at the airport to receive Savitha, who arrived from Uzbekistan with a couple of her compatriots (Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali). As the wait grew longer, he kept pacing around, trying to get in touch with his daughter over the phone. When she emerged, the family seemed overjoyed, with the girl’s grandmother thrilled in the moment.

Savitha is known to raise her level when the situation demands and had shown it when she bagged crucial Elo points before the covid-19 pandemic and in 2022. Now that she has gained important points with a splendid show in Samarkand, she would be motivated to get better and improve her ranking.

She is Chennai’s new superstar in chess and will look to emerge as the next big thing in the Indian sporting firmament.

THE GIST

▼ Savitha’s stunning run at the Olympiad included eight victories and two draws

▼ India women’s team captain Mishra was impressed with her ability to recover from tough positions and win

▼ She presently trains under reputed coach and GM R.B. Ramesh, who counts Praggnanandhaa and Vaishali among his wards



In this Delhi studio, tintype brings chemistry into every portrait

Tintype is a traditional, hand-made photographic process from the mid-19th century that made portrait photography more accessible outside the formal and expensive studios of the time; it seems simple yet it conceals a process that demands scientific precision — and therein lies its charm

Aditya Ansh
NEW DELHI

In an age when a portrait can be made in a fraction of a second, Vibhav Kapoor, artist and assistant professor at O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonipat, spends several minutes making one photograph, much of the time spent negotiating with chemistry.

In his Delhi-NCR studio, Mr. Kapoor works with tintype, a 19th-century photographic process in which an image is created directly on a metal plate.

The French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin is credited with developing the technique in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process.

Chemically demanding

Unlike processes that produced glass negatives or paper prints, tintypes created a positive image directly on a dark metal plate.

Mr. Kapoor takes a plate with collodion, a syrupy solution of nitrocellulose dissolved in ether and alcohol. He pours it onto a metal plate to form a thin, sticky film, and sensitises it in a silver-nitrate bath in which the iodides and bromides react with silver nitrate to form light-sensitive silver iodide and silver bromide.

Finally, he exposes these light-sensitive compounds through a large-format camera, and develops the images in a dark room using a ferrous sulphate solution acidified with glacial acetic acid and thinned with alcohol; it amplifies the latent image by converting more exposed silver halides into visible metallic silver.

The entire sequence from coating to fixing must be completed while the plate remains wet. There is also no negative to reprint from, so duplicating tintypes is equally arduous.

19th century process

In the mid-19th century, the tintype process was valued for being relatively inexpensive and durable. The dominant photographic process of the era was the daguerreotype. It was costly because it required silver-plated copper sheets as the base material plus iodine and mercury vapour to develop images. Together with the labour-intensive crafting process, each daguerreotype was a luxury item.

Tintypes, however, afforded portraits outside the more formal, expensive photographic studios of the period. In India as well, the process formed part of the early history of photography.

In 1864, a British photographer named T. Murray introduced Sawai Ram Singh II



A tintype of Padmanabh Singh, of the erstwhile ruling dynasty of Jaipur State; (Below) portrait in tintype. VIBHAV KAPOOR/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



of Jaipur to the tintype camera and documented his court, architecture, and lives of women in the royal zenana. Murray is also known to have helped the ruler develop a royal archive of visuals.

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Jaipur royal photographer Ram Singh also used the process. “It is a very traditional, hand-made process,” Mr. Kapoor said. But its apparent simplicity conceals a process that demands scientific precision.

Mr. Kapoor first learnt tintype photography during his master’s degree at the Rochester Institute of Technology, New York, which he spent coating plates, photographing, developing, drying, and finally varnishing the finished image.

The way tintype works also affects the photographer and the subject. The CMOS sensors in today’s digital cameras are so fast that a person needs to pose for just a second. On the other hand, the light-sensitive compounds in tintype photography ‘record’ the light over 8-10 seconds, so the subjects need to present themselves still for that period.

For a portrait, as Mr. Kapoor put it,

“The person is performing ..., presenting themselves.”

The image emerges in 10 to 15 minutes thereafter.

Weather and chemistry

That said, the photograph’s most unpredictable component is the weather. “The chemistry is very volatile and humidity plays a crucial role,” Mr. Kapoor said.

“During the monsoon, the humidity causes the tintypes to develop spots,” Matthew Fossier, a U.S. tintype practitioner in Texas, said.

Dust is another serious problem. As dust particles settle on the wet collodion layer, they interrupt the formation of silver halide crystals. When the plate is developed, the affected area produces metallic silver differently from the surrounding film, and which appears as an opaque or transparent spot.

Temperature fluctuations can create other artefacts as well, per Mr. Fossier. The collodion contains volatile solvents and heat makes them evaporate faster, leaving the film to become sticky. The plate must be moved quickly to the silver-nitrate bath, where silver ions react with the halides in the collodion to form the light-sensitive silver-halide layer. If the collodion has begun to set unevenly by

then, however, the resulting layer can be uneven as well.

He added that the effect is pronounced when pouring the collodion, which reduces the time available to get the plate into the silver bath.

According to Mr. Kapoor, the Delhi-NCR temperatures require him to adjust his solutions: “Heat acts as a catalyst [and] more heat means reactions are faster. The developer has to be managed.”

The developer is a chemical solution that reveals the image captured on a sensitised metal plate after exposure. But in warmer weather, the developer works faster, causing streaks or an uneven fog to appear in the picture.

To avoid this, Mr. Kapoor dilutes the developer to change its strength and how long it stays on the plate, slowing the reaction, and allowing the picture to develop clearly.

Photography arrived in India in the 19th century, and the wet-collodion processes became ubiquitous as tintypes circulated in Indian towns in the late 19th and early 20th centuries. Today, however, Mr. Kapoor said “only a handful of photographers in India practise tintype”. (Aditya Ansh is an independent media writer based in New Delhi. adityaansh30@gmail.com)

THE GIST

Tintype created images directly on metal plates; it was developed by French photographer Adolphe Alexandre Martin in 1853, two years after Frederick Scott Archer invented the wet-plate collodion process

The process was popular because it was cheap and durable unlike the more expensive daguerreotype; it made portrait photography accessible to more people outside formal studios

Tintypes became common in towns across the country during the late 19th and early 20th centuries; today, however, only a few photographers in India still practise the process

BIG SHOT



A drone view shows tourists swimming in green seawater associated with a plankton bloom, in Koh Lan, Pattaya, Chonburi province, Thailand. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Silk Road: Eurasia’s web of trade



Cultural crossroad: The main routes of the Silk Road. KELVIN CASE (CC BY-SA)

Vasudevan Mukunth

Contrary to the name, the Silk Road was a network of multiple land and maritime trade routes connecting parts of east, central, south, and west Asia. The network took different shapes over more than a millennium but became especially important from around the second century BC, when China’s Han dynasty expanded west and established contacts with Central Asian states. Because Chinese silk was a prized commodity then, the network was called the Silk Road. Since it offered well-travelled roads, the Silk Road also became the routes that technologies, religions, artistic styles, languages, and natural philosophy took to spread across Eurasia. It is in fact how papermaking spread out from China, as did how Buddhism travelled from India through Central Asia into China. Christianity, Manichaeism, and later Islam also

spread along parts of the network — just like musical traditions, and astrological and medical knowledge.

The network also benefited from the Mongol Empire bringing much of Eurasia within a connected political system in the 13th and 14th centuries, and encouraged long-distance journeys. The Road’s import gradually declined by the early modern period as trade became cheaper over sea routes, especially in the Indian Ocean, while political conditions changed on land. Even so, the network proved instrumental to make premodern Eurasia as economically and culturally interconnected as it had become, despite its size.

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